

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Vast and Perfect Fulfillment of the Great Compassionate Mind of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World, Possessor of a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes, Free from All Obstruction

Āryāvalokiteśvarasya sahasrabhujalocanamahakaruṇācittavistaraparipūrṇanāmadhāraṇī ·
Toh 691 · Derge Kangyur

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ངའ་བའ་ཐུགས་རྒྱུ་ཤེས་པའི་སེམས་རྒྱུ་ཡངས་ས་རྒྱུས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 691 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as "The Vast and Perfect Fulfillment of the Great Compassionate Mind of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Possessor of a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes, Free from All Obstruction," corresponding to the Sanskrit name that can be reconstructed around Avalokiteśvara's celebrated "Great Compassion" (Mahākaruṇā) dhāraṇī, and in Tibetan as Phags pa Chenrezig Wangchuk Chakstong Gyenstong dangldenpa. It belongs to the broader category of dhāraṇī and tantra-related scriptures within the Kangyur, presenting an extensive ritual and liturgical text centered on the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara in his thousand-handed, thousand-eyed form. The text opens with the Buddha Śākyamuni teaching on Mount Potalā, the sacred abode of Avalokiteśvara, surrounded by a vast assembly of bodhisattvas, and proceeds to reveal the powerful dhāraṇī-mantra known as Grasping the Totality, along with its associated practices and merits. As one of the fuller, more elaborate versions of the Great Compassion dhāraṇī literature preserved in Tibetan translation, it holds an important place among the canonical texts dedicated to Avalokiteśvara's compassionate activity.

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The first section.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One Śākyamuni was seated upon a precious lion throne beautifully adorned with various precious jewels, within the maṇḍala of the jewel-adorned palace of the noble Avalokiteśvara, upon the

mountain Potalā, surrounded by precious victory banners and pennants. At that time, the Tathāgata, seated upon that throne and wishing to teach the dhāraṇī-mantra called Grasping the Totality, was accompanied by a countless multitude of great bodhisattvas, all dwelling together, namely: the bodhisattva King of Grasping the Totality, the bodhisattva King of Jewels, the bodhisattva King of Medicine, the bodhisattva Eminently Exalted in Medicine, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva Who Has Attained Great Power, the bodhisattva Array of Lotuses, the bodhisattva Great Array, the bodhisattva Jewel Essence, the bodhisattva Glorious Essence, the bodhisattva Vajra Essence, the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha, the bodhisattva Maitreya, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, and other great bodhisattvas — all of whom had received the empowerment as great sovereign lords of the Dharma, and all of them alone.

Also present together was the great Śrāvaka Saṅgha in its entirety, all beings who had traversed the immeasurable and countless ten grounds of the arhat, with the Venerable Mahākāśyapa as the foremost among them.

Also present together were immeasurably many gods of the Brahmā heaven, with the god-son Kṣaṇḍamara as their foremost.

Also present together were immeasurably many gods and god-sons, with the god-son Kumbhaka as their foremost.

Also present together were immeasurably many world-guardians and divine kings of the four great royal lineages, with the divine king Dhṛtarāṣṭra as their foremost.

Also present together were immeasurably many gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (fragrance-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring), kinnaras (half-human), great mahoragas (great serpents), humans, and non-humans, with the great nāga king Śrī of the Mountain as their foremost.

Also present together were immeasurably many divine daughters of the desire realm, with the divine daughter called Eyes of Youth as their foremost.

And immeasurably many gods of the sky, gods of the rivers, gods of the ocean, gods of the springs, gods of the streams, gods of medicine, gods of trees, gods of forests, gods of dwellings, gods of water, gods of fire, gods of wind, gods of the earth, gods of mountains, gods of palaces, and all such deities — all gathering and arriving from their respective places.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, concealed within the vast assembly, through miraculous power radiated light that caused the world-realms of the ten directions, and this great trichiliocosm as well, to become the color of gold. The celestial palaces of the gods, the dwelling-places of the nāgas, and the palaces of the chiefs of the gods all shook and trembled greatly. The rivers, the lakes, and —

the great oceans, the surrounding mountain ranges, Mount Meru, the earthen mountains, and the dark mountains all shook and trembled greatly. The light of the sun, the moon, jewels, fire, the stars, and the planets was overwhelmed and eclipsed, rendered invisible.

Then the bodhisattva King of Total Retention, beholding these wondrous and marvelous signs — signs such as had never before occurred — was filled with amazement, and rising from his seat, he joined his palms together and spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Who is it, Blessed One, that has displayed these miraculous signs?" And he offered this petition in verse:

Who today has fully awakened,
that they radiate such great rays of light,
turning the worlds of the ten directions to the color of gold,
and this great trichiliocosm likewise?
Who today has attained sovereign mastery,
releasing such wondrous and mighty miraculous power,
that boundless buddha-realms shake and tremble
and the celestial palaces of the gods and nāgas are disturbed?
Not knowing the cause and condition of whose power this is,
this great assembly stands in doubt.
Out of the great compassion of the Blessed One,
may you please declare the cause and condition of this miracle.

The Blessed One then declared to the bodhisattva King of Total Retention: "Son of good family, you should know this: here in this gathered maṇḍala assembly there is a bodhisattva, a great being, called Avalokiteśvara. From immeasurable eons past he has been perfectly endowed with great loving-kindness and great compassion. He has diligently cultivated and accomplished an immeasurable number of dhāraṇī gateways. Wishing benefit and happiness for sentient beings, he concealed himself and displayed this great miraculous power."

When the Blessed One had thus declared this, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara then rose from his seat, arranged his robes, and facing the Blessed One, joined his palms and spoke to the Blessed One as follows: "Blessed One, I possess a dhāraṇī mantra called 'The Mind of Great Compassion.' I wish to proclaim it today so that it may bring healing and happiness to the multitude of sentient beings, may dispel all illness and affliction, may cause long life, may bring wealth and prosperity, may completely purify and cleanse all evil, non-virtuous karma, and weighty offenses, may bring separation from the obstructing hindrances and obscurations, may increase all qualities of the white Dharma, may cause all wholesome seeds to flourish fully, may utterly dispel all fear and dread, and may swiftly and completely fulfill all hopes. Blessed One, please, with loving care, grant your permission."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of good family, you who, out of great compassion, wish to proclaim this awareness-mantra for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings — now is the time; speak it quickly. I, the Tathāgata, and all the buddhas and blessed ones rejoice and approve."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara then spoke again to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I recall clearly: in a past age, as many as a hundred thousand immeasurable eons ago, at that time and in that era, there appeared in this world a Tathāgata, a Blessed One, named the King of a Thousand Lights, the Peacefully Abiding —

That Blessed One, the Tathāgata, out of loving concern for me and for all sentient beings, then bestowed this dhāraṇī called "Great Compassion, Unobstructed, Vast and Perfectly Complete," and with his hand — golden in color — anointed the crown of my head, speaking these words: "Son of good family, take hold of this awareness-mantra of great compassion. It will bring benefit and great happiness to all sentient beings of future times." So he declared.

At that time I was abiding on the very first bodhisattva ground, and merely by hearing this awareness-mantra once, I passed completely beyond the eighth ground. At that time, my mind filled with the greatest joy and gladness, and so I made this aspiration: "If it is truly fitting that I, in future times, shall be one who ripens and brings happiness to all sentient beings, then may a thousand arms and a thousand eyes be fully complete upon this very body of mine right now." No sooner had that aspiration been made than a thousand arms and a thousand eyes appeared fully complete upon my body. The great earth in all

ten directions trembled and quaked in six different ways. The buddhas of all ten directions released rays of light that touched my body, and illuminated all the infinite world-systems of the ten directions.

From then until now I have heard this dhāraṇī again and again and received it perfectly face to face in innumerable maṇḍalas of innumerable assemblies of buddhas, and I have given rise to boundless joy, gladness, and delight — and by this I have passed completely beyond saṃsāra, down to the subtlest trace of it, over a span of innumerable hundreds of thousands of eons.

From now onward, by continuously reciting and fully maintaining this dhāraṇī, never abandoning it, in every single birth I have taken birth by miraculous apparition upon a lotus in the presence of the buddhas, and have never again assumed a body born from a womb.

Therefore, any monk, nun, layman, laywoman, boy, or girl who wishes to recite and fully maintain this dhāraṇī should first arouse in their heart a mind of loving kindness toward all sentient beings, and make to me this aspiration:

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly realize all phenomena.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly obtain the eye of primordial wisdom.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly liberate all sentient beings.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly obtain excellent skillful means.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly be ferried across by the boat of wisdom.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly cross beyond the ocean of suffering.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly attain the path of moral discipline as my foot.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly ascend the mountain of nirvāṇa.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.
May I swiftly reach the unconditioned home.

I bow to the lord Avalokiteśvara, great in compassion.

May I swiftly become equal with the dharmakāya, the body that is the nature of reality.

Should I ascend a mountain of swords —
may the mountain of swords collapse of itself.

Should I encounter boiling water —
may the fires beneath the boiling water be quenched of themselves.

Should I descend into the hells —

may the hells dry up of themselves.

Should I arrive in the realm of hungry ghosts —
may hunger and thirst be fully satisfied.

Should I arrive in the realm of the asuras —
may malicious thoughts be tamed of themselves.

Should I go to the realm of animals —
may I myself attain the great wisdom.

Having made aspirations in these words, with one-pointed mind I will recite and hold in memory this name of mine. Furthermore, having called to mind my teacher, the Tathāgata Amitābha, and then, at a single session, reciting this dhāraṇī mantra a full seven times, all heavy misdeeds that would otherwise cause one to wander in cyclic existence for eight hundred thousand million aeons will be utterly purified and cleansed.

The following was also addressed to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if any god or person whatsoever recites and holds the words of Great Compassion, then at the moment of death the Tathāgatas of all ten directions will come to that place and extend their hands; and in whatever buddha-fields one aspires to be reborn, one will be born there exactly as one has prayed."

The following was also addressed to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if any sentient being whatsoever recites and fully holds this awareness-mantra of Great Compassion, and yet falls into the three lower destinies, then I shall never attain perfect and complete awakening. If those who recite and fully hold this awareness-mantra of Great Compassion are not reborn in the buddha-fields, I shall never attain perfect and complete awakening. If those who recite and fully hold this awareness-mantra of Great Compassion do not attain measureless meditative absorption and confidence, I shall never attain perfect and complete awakening. If those who recite and fully hold this awareness-mantra of Great Compassion do not have all their aspirations

fulfilled in this very life, exactly as they have prayed, then this shall not be called the dhāraṇī of the mind of Great Compassion — with the sole exception of those who have committed non-virtue and have not practiced with one-pointed mind.

If any woman, utterly weary of a woman's body, wishes to obtain the body of a man, let her recite and fully hold the words of this dhāraṇī of the mind of Great Compassion. If, having entirely transformed from the condition of being a woman, she does not obtain the body of a man, I shall never attain perfect and complete awakening. Yet should even a slight thought of doubt arise, her aspiration will certainly not come to manifest fruition.

Any sentient being who steals and consumes the food and property of the Saṅgha — even if such a one were to confess and disclose their remorse before a thousand buddhas appearing in the world, they would not be purified and cleansed. Yet by merely uttering this awareness-mantra of Great Compassion, such persons will be utterly purified. As for those who steal and consume the food and wealth of the Three Jewels, if they confess before the Teachers of all ten directions appearing directly and in person, then at last they will be utterly purified. And when this dhāraṇī of Great Compassion is recited, the Teachers of all ten directions come to that place and preside, and through that all the obscurations of misdeeds are utterly purified — the ten non-virtues, the five acts of immediate retribution, the maligning of persons, the maligning of the Dharma, the breaking of the restoration ceremony, the breaking of moral discipline,

the destruction of stūpas, the destruction of all temples, the theft of the Saṅgha's property, the defilement of perfectly pure celibate conduct — all heavy misdeeds of this kind and the like will be utterly purified.

There is but one thing concerning this awareness mantra about which doubt is to be entertained: if doubt arises, then even the lightest and most minor of misdeeds will not be utterly purified — to say nothing, of course, of heavy misdeeds. As for those heavy misdeeds, they will not be utterly purified; yet even so, they will become a cause for prolonging the way to awakening.

The following was also said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, whatever gods or humans recite and hold this awareness mantra of the mind of Great Compassion will attain fifteen auspicious births and will not be made to die the fifteen kinds of bad death. The fifteen kinds of bad death are these: that person will not die tormented by hunger; will not die by weapons or clubs; will

not die at the hands of an enemy bearing enmity; will not die on the field of battle; will not die in the jaws of tigers, wolves, or vicious predators; will not die in the jaws of venomous serpents, scorpions, or malevolent creatures; will not die by drowning in water or burning in fire; will not die by poison; will not be brought to death's hour by sorcery and black magic; will not die having gone mad and lost mindfulness; will not die by falling from a mountain, a tree, a cliff, or a precipice; will not be brought to death's hour by the spells of malicious persons; will not be brought to death's hour by having been found vulnerable by malevolent and perverse spirits and demons; will not be brought to death's hour by a virulent disease binding itself to the body; and will not be brought to death's hour by self-inflicted harm through inappropriate means. Those who recite and fully hold this awareness mantra of Great Compassion will not be brought to death's hour by these fifteen kinds of bad death.

The fifteen auspicious births that will be attained are these: in every birth one will encounter virtuous kings; one will always be born in a virtuous land; one will always encounter auspicious times; one will always encounter a virtuous spiritual friend; one will always have one's bodily faculties complete; the mind of the path will become one's habitual disposition; one will not allow one's vowed moral discipline to degenerate; all those in one's retinue will be bound together and harmonized through kindness; the necessities of life will always be present and abundant; one will always be honored and attended to by others; one's possessions will not be seized by others; whatever one aspires to in mind will be accomplished according to one's wish; virtuous gods and nāgas will always guard and fully protect one; in every birth one will see buddhas and hear the Dharma; having heard the authentic Dharma, one will realize its profound meaning.

Whatever gods or humans recite and fully hold this dhāraṇī of the mind of Great Compassion will attain these fifteen auspicious births. Therefore all gods and humans should constantly recite and fully hold it and should not give rise to laziness."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, having spoken these words, then joined his palms together before the assembled retinue, sat upright, and aroused the mind of great compassion toward all sentient beings. With a countenance of gentle smiling radiance, he then pronounced these beautiful words of the dhāraṇī called "The Great Compassionate Mind, Vast and Perfectly Complete, Unobstructed":

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namas āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: om sarva-bandhana-cchedana-karāya, sarva-pāpa-samudrocchośaṇa-karāya, sarva-vyādhi-praśamana-karāya, sarva-ityupadrava-vināśana-karāya, sarva-bhayeṣṭārāṇa-karāya. Tasya. Namas kṛtvā idaṃ āryāvalokiteśvarāya tava nīlakaṇṭha-nāma-parama-hṛdayam āvartayiṣyāmi. Sarvārtha-sādhanaṃ śubha-cetanaṃ sarva-bhūtānāṃ pāpa-mārga-viśodhakam. Tadyathā: āloke, adhipati, loka-atikrānte, ehyehi, mahā-bodhisattva, he mahā-bodhisattva, he priya-bodhisattva, he mahā-kāruṇika — mahā-smara hṛdayam. Ehyehi āryāvalokiteśvarāya parama-maitri-citta-kāruṇika, kuru kuru, karma-sādhaya sādhaya, vidyāṃ dehe dehi — me araṃ gamam gama vihaṃgama. Siddha-yogīśvara, duhu duhu, vīryante mahā-vīryante. Dhara dhara, dharendreśvara. Cala cala, vimala-mūrte āryāvalokiteśvara. Jina-kṛṣṇa-jaṭā-mukuṭa, alaṃkṛta-śarīra, lamba-pralamba-vilamba. Mahāsiddha-vidyādhara, bala bala mahā-bala, mala mala mahā-mala, cala cala mahā-cala. Kṛṣṇa-varṇa kṛṣṇa-pakṣa, kṛṣṇa-pāśa nirghātana. He padma-hasta, cara cara niścāreśvare. Kṛṣṇa-sarva-kṛtaya-jñopavīta. Ehyehi mahā-vārāha-mukha, tripura-dahaneśvara. Nārāyaṇa-bala-rūpa-veśa-dhara. He nīlakaṇṭha, ehyehi. Mahā-hala-hala-viśa-nirjita. Lokasya rāga-viśa-vināśanaṃ, dveṣa-viśa-vināśanaṃ, moha-viśa-vināśanaṃ. Nirmokṣaṇa hulu hulu, muñca muñca, muhu muhu, rāhula rāhula, hala halā, hāre mahā-padma-nābhi. Sara sara, siri siri, suru suru. Buddhyu buddhyu, bodhaya bodhaya, bodhayāmi tava nīlakaṇṭha. Ehyehi nīlakaṇṭha, ehyehi vāma-sthita-mahā-siṃha-mukha. Hasa hasa, muñca muñca mahā-ṭaṭa-hāsyā. Ehyehi bho bho mahāsiddha-yogīśvara, bhaṇa bhaṇa, vāca sādhaya sādhaya, vidyāṃ smara smara tvam. He bhagavan, tāloka-vilokatvaṃ tathāgatānāṃ, dadāhi me darśana-kāmasya darśanaṃ. Prasādhaya me svāhā. Siddhaya svāhā. Mahā-siddhāya svāhā. Siddha-yogīśvarāya svāhā. Nīlakaṇṭhāya svāhā. Vārāha-mukhāya svāhā. Mahā-vārāha-mukhāya svāhā. Nara-siṃha-mukhāya svāhā. Mahā-nara-siṃha-mukhāya svāhā. Vajra-hastāya svāhā. Mahā-vajra-hastāya svāhā. Siddha-vidyādhārāya svāhā. Mahāsiddha-vidyādhārāya svāhā. Padma-hastāya svāhā. Mahā-padma-hastāya svāhā. Kṛṣṇa-sarva-kṛtaya-jñopavītāya svāhā. Mahā-māla-mukuṭa-dharāya svāhā. Cakrāyudha-dharāya svāhā. Śaṅkha-śabda-nirṇādana-karāya svāhā. Bodhana-karāya svāhā. Vāma-skandha-deśa-sthita-kṛṣṇājīnāya svāhā. Vāma-hasta-vyāghra-carma-nivāsanāya svāhā. Lokeśvarāya svāhā. Mahā-lokeśvarāya svāhā. Sarva-siddheśvarāya svāhā. Rakṣa rakṣa māṃ

svāhā. Kuru-rakṣa-mudrāṇāṃ svāhā. Namo bhagavate āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Sidhyantu me mantra-padāni svāhā.

The moment the noble bodhisattva, the great being, Avalokiteśvara spoke this dhāraṇī vidyā mantra, the great earth trembled and quaked in six ways. The gods rained down a shower of precious flowers. The buddhas of the ten directions rejoiced in their hearts. The māras who are sons of gods and the tīrthikas trembled with fear, their hair standing on end. Among all the many beings gathered in the assembly, some attained the fruit of stream-entry, some attained the fruit of once-returning, some attained the fruit of non-returning, and some attained the fruit of arhatship. Some attained the first ground, the second ground, the third ground, the fourth ground, and the fifth ground, and on up through the attainment of the tenth ground. Immeasurable numbers of sentient beings gave rise to the awakening mind directed toward awakening.

Then the Great Brahmā rose from his seat, arranged his robes, and with reverent palms pressed together, spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the great being, Avalokiteśvara: "Excellent, O great being! In the past I have heard immeasurable assemblies of Tathāgatas teach many and various kinds of Dharma and many and various kinds of dhāraṇī; yet never before have I heard such exquisite words as this vidyā mantra of the great dhāraṇī of the mind of great compassion, the unobstructed one. O great being, I beseech you to explain to us at length the characteristics of the sphere of this dhāraṇī. We of the great assembly are deeply eager to hear it."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara replied to the Great Brahmā: "O King of the Gods, you have asked thus out of skillful means, for the sake of benefiting all sentient beings. Now listen well, for I shall explain it to you briefly."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke: "It is the mind of great compassion. It is the mind of equanimity. It is the mind of the unconditioned. It is the mind free from attachment. It is the mind that views things as like emptiness. It is the mind of reverence. It is the mind of the sublime. It is the mind without mixture. It is the mind of unsurpassed awakening, that is, bodhicitta. Know that whatever minds are of this nature — these are the defining characteristics of the dhāraṇī. You must accomplish it in exactly this way."

The great King Brahmā said: "We of the great assembly have today come to understand what these defining characteristics of the dhāraṇī truly are. From

this day forward, having fully grasped them, I am utterly unable to let them be forgotten."

The noble Avalokiteśvara spoke: "Whatever son or daughter of good family recites and fully holds this vidyā mantra, let them give rise to the vast awakening mind, bodhicitta, and genuinely take up the commitment to lead all sentient beings to complete liberation from saṃsāra. Dwelling oneself in the restoration ceremony and in ethical discipline, give rise to the mind of equanimity toward all sentient beings, and recite this vidyā mantra continually without interruption. Sitting within a clean dwelling place, having bathed thoroughly and put on clean clothes, having raised banners and lit lamps, and having made offerings of incense, flowers, and food, with the mind focused in one-pointed concentration — not attending to any other, different object — and reciting and holding it in proper accord with the Dharma: at that time the bodhisattva Sūryavairocana (Sunlight), the bodhisattva Candravairocana (Moonlight), and immeasurable numbers of sages will come to that place, conferring power and also showing auspicious signs. And I too will at that time look upon that person with a thousand eyes."

And with a thousand hands I will protect and bless that person, so that they will come to master all the worldly arts and sciences, however many there may be. All the ritual ceremonies and spells of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), however many there are, they will understand and fully comprehend. Whoever recites and holds this vidyā-mantra will cure the eighty-four thousand kinds of spirits and diseases found in the world, and bring those afflicted back to health. They will gain dominion over all demons and spirits, and will tame even the māras who are sons of the gods. They will put an end to the non-Buddhists.

If one dwells on a mountain or in a wilderness, reciting sūtras and practising meditative concentration, and the mountain deities and demons and spirits cause harm, persistently creating disturbances so that one is rendered unable to enter meditative equipoise — then if this vidyā-mantra is recited even once, all those demons and spirits will be destroyed.

If one recites it in proper accord with the Dharma and arouses a mind of loving compassion toward all sentient beings, then at that time I will command the gods of virtue, all the nāga kings, and the Vajrapāṇis — the keepers of secrets — to follow that person always and protect them fully. "Dwell in that person's vicinity and guard them as you would the apple of your own eye. Protect them as you would your own life-force." This I will proclaim.

And in order to show to whom this proclamation is addressed, the following verse was spoken:

I send forth the Lord of Secrets, Vajradhara,
the one encircled by nectar, with the crested hook,
the mighty Śaṃkara and the eight divisions —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the Sovereign (Śiva), the greatly powerful one,
Kubera, and the lords of the yellow-robe wearers —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the guardian of wealth and the water deity,
Subhaga, and Pārijāta —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth Sāraṃca, Mahāra,
Kulantanta, and the five glorious ones —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the king of the pippal tree,
glorious Pyita, and Svārahārā —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth Brahmā and Saṃvara,
the five divisions of the Pure Abodes, and the marsh deities —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth Śakra (Indra), the thirty-three gods,
the greatly courageous and glorious one, and Sātana —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the king Dhṛtarāṣṭra
and the mighty retinue of Māmakī and the gods —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth king Virūḍhaka
and Virūpākṣa and Vaiśravaṇa —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the golden-hued king of peacocks,
the twenty-eight division commanders and their retinue of sages —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the excellent jewels
and the great chieftain Sthāvara-Pulapa —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth Nandaka and Upanandaka,
the nāga king of the ocean, and the elapatra —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the asuras, the gandharvas,
the garuḍas, the kinnaras, and the serpents —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

I send forth the deities of water, fire, and lightning,
the lords of the pot and the flesh-eaters —
let them always guard and hold this dhāraṇī.

Those gods of virtue, the nāga kings, the Māmakī and the rest — each of them
accompanied by a retinue of five hundred —

let those powerful yakṣas always recite and uphold the vidyā-mantra of great
compassion, and by guarding and protecting whoever upholds it — even if that
person should sleep alone on a mountain or in a deserted place, those virtuous
gods will guard him through each night and utterly clear away all hindrances
and obstacles.

If one has gone into ravines and gorges and become lost on the way, and then
recites this vidyā-mantra, then through that power the virtuous gods and the
nāga kings will visibly emanate in the form of good human beings and show
the true and correct path.

If one is dwelling in mountains, forests, or desolate places and is left without
water or fire, the nāga kings, in order to protect such a person, will cause
water and fire to appear by emanation.

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara then, for the sake of those who recite and
uphold this dhāraṇī, in order to remove harm and obstacles, spoke these most
cooling verses:

One who has gone to mountains and remote wilderness,
and meets with tigers, wolves, fierce beasts of prey,
with biting insects, serpents, and malevolent spirits —
if they hear this dhāraṇī recited, these cannot harm them.

One who has entered rivers or the ocean,
and encounters venomous nāgas, savage sea-monsters,
yakṣas, rākṣasas, fish, and crocodiles —
if they hear this dhāraṇī, each will scatter and flee.

One who is in the midst of battle, surrounded by foes,
or when vicious bandits seize their wealth —
if they recite the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind,
those enemies will give rise to loving feeling and turn away.

One who is caught in a royal legal case,
bound in iron chains and thrown into prison —
if they recite the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind,
the king, moved by kindly feeling, will release them.

One who has entered a house of sorcery and poison arrows,
and is being killed by food and drink laced with poison —
if they recite the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind,
the poison itself will become nectar, and food and drink will be wholesome.

When a woman is pregnant and the time of birth has come,
and māra creates obstacles so the pain becomes unbearable —
if she recites the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind,
the demonic possession will be expelled and the birth will be easy.

When a fierce nāga-spirit breathes out its venomous breath,
and one falls gravely ill with fever-sickness and is near death —
if they recite the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind,
the epidemic illness will be cleared and life prolonged.

When a wandering nāga-spirit afflicts one with swelling,
with unbearable tumors, and with flowing pus and blood —
if one recites the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind
and applies saliva three times, the swelling will be pacified.

When sentient beings, through distorted thought, generate non-virtue,
and are then afflicted by sorcery, harmful spells, and enemies —
if they recite the dhāraṇī of great compassion with one-pointed mind,
all the harm of those spells will be gathered upon the one who sent them.

When, in this age of dregs, sin increases and the holy Dharma decays,
and the great fire of desire bewilders and perverts the mind —
when spouses, drifting apart, each crave attachment to another,

and wrong thoughts flow without ceasing, day and night —
if one recites the dhāraṇī of great compassion,
the fire of desire will be quenched and the perverted mind cleared away.

Were I to extensively expound the power and might of this dhāraṇī,
even were it proclaimed for an entire aeon, it would never reach its end.

Recite this vidyā-mantra five times, tie twenty-four knots in a five-colored
thread, and hang it around the neck.

This dhāraṇī was taught by Tathāgatas of the past as numerous as the grains
of sand in ninety-nine Ganges rivers.

Those Tathāgatas taught this dhāraṇī so that yogins who have not yet fully
completed the six perfections may complete them; so that those who have not
yet generated the mind of awakening may swiftly generate it; so that those
śrāvaka persons who have not yet actualized the fruit may swiftly actualize it;
so that the sages dwelling in this great trichiliocosm who have not yet
generated the mind of unsurpassed awakening may swiftly generate it; and so
that, through the power of the blessing of this dhāraṇī, the seed of the Great
Vehicle and the sprout of the Dharma may grow in sentient beings who have
not yet obtained the faculty of faith in this Great Vehicle. It is for these reasons
that it was taught, and through my skillful means and through the power of
loving-kindness and compassion, I cause all of them to obtain whatever they
desire.

Furthermore, however many sentient beings of the three lower destinies dwell
in places of darkness and deep gloom within this great trichiliocosm — should
they come to hear this vidyā-mantra of mine, all of them will be freed from
suffering. Those bodhisattvas who have not yet attained the first ground will
swiftly attain it, and those who have not yet attained up to the tenth ground
will attain it. Moreover, because this brings one all the way to the ground of
buddhahood, the thirty-two major marks and eighty minor marks of a great
being will be obtained spontaneously of their own accord.

If any śrāvaka person hears this dhāraṇī even once with their own ears, or
recites this dhāraṇī, or copies it in writing, or dwells in the Dharma with an
upright mind — the four fruits of the contemplative life will be attained
spontaneously, without having to seek them.

Within this great trichiliocosm, all the waters of mountains, rivers, streams, cliffs, and the four great oceans can be made to surge and boil. From Mount Meru and Sumeru all the way to the surrounding iron mountain range — these too can be shaken and shattered like particles of dust. All sentient beings dwelling therein can be caused to generate the mind of unsurpassed awakening.

Sentient beings who wish to fulfill aspirations in this very life: if they observe the restoration ceremony and abide in moral discipline for twenty-one days while reciting this dhāraṇī, without doubt all their aspirations will be fulfilled. All sinful actions without exception, from one end of saṃsāra to the other, will be entirely purified.

However many buddhas and bodhisattvas dwell within and beyond this great trichiliocosm, together with all the Brahmās, Śakras, the four great kings, gods, sages, and nāga kings dwelling therein — all of them will come to know and understand.

Whatever god or human recites and upholds this dhāraṇī, and enters a river or ocean to bathe — if the water with which they have washed their body comes into contact with the bodies of sentient beings dwelling there, all their sinful actions and heavy misdeeds will be entirely purified, and they will be born by miraculous apparition from a lotus in a pure land. They will not take birth from a womb, from heat and moisture, or from an egg. How much more needless to say this applies to those who uphold, retain, read, and recite this dhāraṇī aloud.

When those who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī travel along a road and a great wind arises — if the wind that has touched that person's body, body hair, head hair, and clothing then blows downwind and comes into contact with the bodies of other sentient beings — all those beings' obscurations and heavy sinful actions, without exception, will be entirely

purified. Those beings will no longer experience karmic maturation in any of the three lower destinies, and they will be perpetually reborn in the presence of a buddha. Therefore, know that the merit and the ripening of its fruit that accrues to those who uphold this dhāraṇī is inconceivable.

Whatever words issue from the mouth of one who recites this dhāraṇī — whether virtuous or non-virtuous — if the māras who are sons of gods, non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), gods, nāgas, and all spirits and demons hear those words, every one of them will be transformed into the utterly pure

dharmadhātu. And having generated a mind of reverence toward that person as they would toward a buddha, they will honor and serve him.

Know that those who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī are themselves a treasury of the buddha's body, for buddhas as numerous as the grains of sand in ninety-nine billion Ganges rivers hold them dear and cherish them. Know that such a person is a treasury of a body endowed with light, for all the Tathāgatas cause them to shine with their rays of light. Know that such a person is a treasury of loving-kindness and compassion, for through this dhāraṇī they completely protect all sentient beings. Know that such a person is a vessel of the sacred Dharma, for they gather together all the doors of the dhāraṇī. Know that such a person is a vessel of meditative concentration and meditative absorption (samādhi), for hundreds of thousands of samādhis perpetually become directly manifest to them. Know that such a person is a treasury of space, for they continually look upon sentient beings with the wisdom of emptiness. Know that such a person is a treasury of fearlessness, for gods, nāgas, and the gods of virtue perpetually guard and protect them without fail. Know that such a person is a treasury of sacred speech, for the sound of the dhāraṇī that issues from their mouth is unceasing. Know that such a person is a treasury of permanent abiding, for the great conflagrations of the three terrors cannot destroy them. Know that such a person is a treasury of liberation, for māras who are sons of gods and non-Buddhists are unable to lead them astray. Know that such a person is a treasury of the king of medicine, for through the dhāraṇī they continually heal the illnesses of sick sentient beings. Know that such a person is a treasury of miraculous powers, for they gain sovereign mastery in traveling freely through buddha realms.

Therefore, even if one were to set forth an account of the praises of that person's qualities, it would never reach an end.

O son of good family, should anyone who has grown utterly weary of worldly suffering wish to seek the medicine of long life, they should sit in a secluded place, completely cut off the boundaries of the retreat, recite the mantra over their clothing and put it on, and then recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over water, food, incense, and medicine and make use of them — and they will without doubt gain long life. If one observes the boundary in accordance with the Dharma and upholds the retreat in accordance with the Dharma, everything will be perfectly accomplished.

The ritual for establishing the boundary is as follows: recite the mantra twenty-one times over a sword, draw a line on the ground, and establish the boundary. Alternatively, recite the mantra twenty-one times over clean water, scatter it in the four directions, and thereby establish the boundary. Alternatively, recite the mantra twenty-one times over white mustard seeds, scatter them in the four directions, and thereby establish the boundary. Or alternatively, wherever one mentally intends to go shall become the boundary.

Alternatively, recite the mantra twenty-one times over clean ash, and thereby establish the boundary. Alternatively, recite the mantra twenty-one times over a cord of five-colored thread, wind it around in the four directions, and thereby establish the boundary.

If one upholds this practice completely in accordance with the Dharma in this way, the result will be attained of its own accord. If the mere hearing of the name of this dhāraṇī purifies the heavy burden of moral transgressions accumulated in cyclic existence over immeasurable eons, what need is there even to speak of reciting and holding it? Know that those persons who recite this mantra of awareness are thereby making offerings and rendering service to immeasurable buddhas, and are generating roots of virtue in great abundance.

Know that those who recite it properly in order to guide sentient beings away from the obstacles of suffering are possessed of great compassion, and will swiftly, without long delay, come to fully and perfectly awaken. To whatever extent one recites it for the sake of all sentient beings who appear, causing it to resound in their ears and thereby planting the cause of awakening — the immeasurable and incalculable qualities that those persons will attain are beyond the power of speech to express.

If someone, with one-pointed mind, with body and mind observing the restoration ceremony and abiding in moral discipline, first confesses the karmic transgressions of all sentient beings from former lives, then openly confesses the various kinds of negative actions one has oneself committed since beginningless time over immeasurable eons, and then swiftly recites this dhāraṇī aloud without interruption in an unbroken stream of sound — those four fruits of the contemplative life will be attained in this very lifetime.

If one is a person of sharp faculties, possessed of wisdom, and skilled in the methods of meditation, even the fruit of the ten grounds will be attained without difficulty — to say nothing of the mundane ripening of merit through

the pursuit of minor aims, which will be accomplished effortlessly. This is because of the profoundly deep power of the great compassion and aspirational prayers of the bodhisattva, and because of the exceedingly vast blessing of this dhāraṇī.

The Blessed One then spoke to Ānanda: In whatever lands calamities arise, at that time let the king of that land govern the realm with righteous Dharma and settle the people in ease and freedom from anxiety. Let him not take the lives of sentient beings, and having fully protected those who have committed offenses, let him arouse physical and mental diligence for seven days and nights and recite this dhāraṇī mantra of the mind of great compassion. All calamities and obstacles in that land will be entirely dispelled, the harvests will be good, and the many people will dwell in happiness.

Furthermore, if enemy forces from without come again and again to cause harm, making many subjects miserable, or if a great minister plots treachery and becomes disloyal, or if epidemic disease breaks out, or if a great earthquake occurs, or if the courses of the sun and moon go awry — if calamities such as these arise, then at that time let one fashion an image of a thousand eyes endowed with great compassion, have it face in the appropriate direction, and with one-pointed mind make offerings of incense, flowers, victory banners, pennants, various kinds of precious canopies, and foods and drinks possessing a hundred flavors.

Furthermore, if that king, rousing physical and mental diligence for seven days and nights, recites these excellent words of the dhāraṇī, the enemy forces from without will subdue themselves and withdraw, and each in their own place will govern their lands rightly; and those lands, dwelling together in harmony, will look upon one another with minds of loving-kindness.

The princes and ministers too will become loyal and will conduct themselves with rectitude. The queens and consorts will become loyal and respectful toward the king. Gods, nāgas, and malevolent spirits will guard and protect that land. Rain will fall in its proper season, the harvests will be excellent, and the multitude of people will rejoice greatly.

Furthermore, if a household is afflicted by grave and malignant illness, or if various ill omens arise, or if malevolent spirits and perverse māras disturb the household, or if wicked people slander and scheme to cause harm, or if the members of the household, great and small, fall into discord within and without — then one should create a maṇḍala before an image fashioned in the

form of the thousand-eyed one endowed with great compassion, hold the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara one-pointedly in mind, and recite this dhāraṇī mantra a full thousand times. All those evil conditions enumerated above will be entirely purified.

The venerable Ānanda then addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, what is the name of this vidyā mantra? And how is one to retain it?" The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, this vidyā mantra has many names. It may be called the Vast and Perfectly Complete. It may be called the Great Compassion That Knows No Impediment. It may be called the Dhāraṇī That Utterly Protects from All Suffering. It may be called the Dhāraṇī That Extends Life. It may be called the Dhāraṇī That Thoroughly Purifies the Lower Realms. It may be called the Dhāraṇī That Utterly Destroys the Obscuration of Karma. It may be called the Dhāraṇī That Perfectly Fulfills Aspirations. It may be called the Dhāraṇī That Follows the Mind and Grants Autonomy. And it may be called the Dhāraṇī That Swiftly Advances Through the Higher Grounds. Thus shall it be retained."

The venerable Ānanda then addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, what is the name of this great bodhisattva — this bodhisattva, this great being — who is so skilled in revealing such a dhāraṇī?" The Blessed One declared: "This bodhisattva's name is Avalokiteśvara. He may also be called the Noose of Meaningful Purpose. He may also be called the One Possessed of a Thousand Eyes of Light. O son of good family, the name, the splendor, and the power of this bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara are inconceivable. He fully awakened to buddhahood measureless aeons ago in the past, and even then his name as a Tathāgata was True Light of the Dharma; yet by the power of his great compassion and his aspirational prayers, in order to bring beings to happiness, he manifests in the body of a bodhisattva. Therefore, in the great retinue of this bodhisattva, this great being, you, together with Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), gods, and nāgas, should honor him with reverence and not despise him. When all gods and humans continually make offerings to him and recite his name one-pointedly, they will obtain merit beyond measure, and transgressions beyond measure will be wholly purified. And after this life, they will be born in the realm of the Tathāgata Amitābha."

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, if one wishes to become abundantly wealthy, replete with every kind of precious thing, one should make offerings to the hand holding the wish-fulfilling jewel. If one is oppressed by various forms of misfortune, one should make offerings to the hand holding the noose.

If one has illness in the belly, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious vessel. If one wishes to subdue all malevolent spirits and possessing forces, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious sword."

If one wishes to subdue all the māras of divine sons, one should make offerings to the hand holding the vajra. If one wishes to defeat adversarial enemies who attack from without, one should make offerings to the hand holding the vajra hammer. If one wishes to be freed from every situation of fear and dread, one should make offerings to the hand that bestows fearlessness. If the eyes have become dim and lacking in light, one should make offerings to the hand holding the crystal gemstone. If one has been struck by a fever and wishes to be cooled, one should make offerings to the hand holding the water-crystal gemstone. If one wishes for an elevated and resourceful intellect, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious bow. If one wishes to swiftly meet with dear companions and close friends, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious arrow. If one's body has been afflicted by various illnesses, one should make offerings to the hand holding the long staff. If one wishes to clear away the malevolent obstructing spirits of the body, one should make offerings to the hand holding the white fly-whisk. If one wishes that all beings around one become harmonious companions, one should make offerings to the hand holding the vase. If one wishes to drive away tigers, leopards, bears, wolves, and all malevolent wild beasts, one should make offerings to the hand holding the canopy. If one wishes to be freed from royal obstacles in all places and at all times, one should make offerings to the hand holding the battle-axe. For the sake of sons, daughters, and attendants, one should make offerings to the hand holding the crystal earring. For the sake of various kinds of excellent qualities, one should make offerings to the hand holding the white lotus. If one wishes to be born in the utterly pure pure lands of the ten directions, one should make offerings to the hand holding the blue lotus. If one wishes to be endowed with great wisdom, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious mirror. If one wishes to directly behold the Tathāgatas of the ten directions, one should make offerings to the hand holding the red lotus. If one wishes to draw forth the treasures of the earth, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious jeweled basket. If one wishes to accomplish the path of the sages (ṛṣis) directly, one should make offerings to the hand holding the five-colored cloud. If one wishes to be born in the Brahma realm, one

should make offerings to the hand holding the water vessel. If one wishes to be born in a divine palace, one should make offerings to the hand holding the lotus-flower staff. If one wishes to repel the attack of enemies from other directions, one should make offerings to the hand holding the sword and spear. If one wishes to summon all virtuous gods and spirits, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious conch. If one wishes to drive away all gods and spirits, one should make offerings to the hand holding the skull-staff. If one wishes that the buddhas of the ten directions swiftly come and anoint one with their hands, one should make offerings to the hand holding the prayer beads. If one wishes to fully accomplish all the most supreme and sacred Brahma-voice melodies, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious bell. If one wishes to be endowed with excellent eloquence of speech, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious mudrā. If one wishes that virtuous gods and nāgas come always, protecting and thoroughly guarding one, one should make offerings to the hand holding the iron hook. If one wishes to protect all sentient beings fully with loving-kindness and compassion, one should make offerings to the hand holding the ringed staff. If one wishes that all sentient beings always attend upon one another with respect and hold one another in affection, one should make offerings to the hand holding the joined palms. If one wishes never to be separated from the Tathāgatas in all birth-places and in all future lives, one should make offerings to the hand holding the emanated buddha. If one wishes, throughout all future lifetimes, always to dwell in the Tathāgata's palace and never again be born in the core of a womb, one should make offerings to the hand holding the emanated palace. If one wishes to be endowed with the broad knowledge of extensive learning, one should make offerings to the hand holding the precious sūtra volume.

If one wishes never to turn back from the awakening mind, from this very life until one reaches the body of a buddha, one should make offerings to the hand holding the golden wheel of non-return. If one wishes that the Tathāgatas of the ten directions swiftly come, stroke one's crown with their hands, and bestow a prophecy, one should make offerings to the hand at the crown holding the emanated buddha. If one wishes to bring forth fruits and grains, one should make offerings to the hand holding the cluster of grapes. Although there exist a thousand rites of accomplishment, they have here been condensed and only a brief account has been given.

The Blessed One then declared: "Ānanda, with a mind of utterly pure faith, take up this dhāraṇī and spread it widely throughout Jambudvīpa without interruption. This dhāraṇī bestows great benefit upon all sentient beings of the three realms who are afflicted by illness; when they are healed by this dhāraṇī, there is not one who will fail to recover. If this great vidyā mantra, when applied even to a withered tree, causes it to put forth branches, leaves, blossoms, and fruit, then what need is there to speak of sentient beings endowed with consciousness? When it heals sentient beings struck down by illness, there is no case that cannot be cured. Noble son, since the blessing and power of this dhāraṇī are inconceivable, even were one to recite inconceivable praises, they would never reach an end. If one has not accumulated vast roots of virtue over a long expanse of time gone by, one will not even hear its name, let alone behold it directly. Let all of you — the great assembly of gods, humans, nāgas, and the rest — having heard me recite these praises of this dhāraṇī, rejoice with one accord. Know that if anyone should disparage this vidyā mantra, they will thereby have disparaged buddhas equal in number to the grains of sand of ninety-nine hundred-thousands of Ganges rivers. Know too that if a person arises in doubt and disbelief toward this dhāraṇī, that person will be forever parted from great benefit and will wander in the lower destinies for a measure of hundreds of thousands of eons without the time ever coming to emerge; they will never see a buddha, never hear the Dharma, and never behold the Saṅgha."

All the great bodhisattvas assembled in that retinue, together with Vajrapāṇi the Lord of Secrets, Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), the Four Great Kings, gods, nāgas, and all spirits and demons — having heard the Blessed One recite the praises of this dhāraṇī, all rejoiced with delight and gladness, received the teaching well, and proceeded to accomplish it.

Then the bodhisattva Sūryaprabhā (Sunlight) spoke this great vidyā mantra for the sake of fully protecting those who hold the dhāraṇī of great compassion:

Namo buddhagurave. Namo dharma mahāte. Namaḥ saṃgha trayāṇi tri pu pi sātataṃ namaḥ.

When this vidyā mantra is recited, all transgressions are completely purified, māras are expelled, and obstructors are removed. After each recitation, offer a bow to the buddha. Likewise, if one recites the vidyā mantra three times each day and bows to the buddha, then in all future lives one will attain the ripening of the fruit of possessing an exceedingly beautiful and attractive appearance,

life after life.

The bodhisattva Candraprabhā (Moonlight) then spoke this dhāraṇī for the sake of fully protecting yogins:

Sinti te duṣoṣṭha. Ajñāmite atuṣṭha.

Sinakhita bali tiṣṭhā. Yamijñāta odhustha. Kulatimashta khishtha svāhā.

After reciting this vidyā mantra five times, one should tie mantra-knots on a five-colored thread and fasten it wherever it is to be worn.

This vidyā mantra was proclaimed by buddhas of the past as numerous as the grains of sand in forty Ganges rivers. Therefore I too now teach it for the purpose of fully protecting yogins, for the purpose of completely removing all obstructors, for the purpose of completely removing all illness and malady, for the purpose of bringing all virtuous qualities to complete perfection, and for the purpose of completely eliminating all fear and terror.

The Blessed One then declared: "Ānanda, this vidyā mantra taught by the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is wholly true; there is nothing false in it whatsoever. If one wishes that this bodhisattva come into one's presence, one should consecrate gugul resin by reciting the mantra over it twenty-one times and burn it, and the bodhisattva will come.

If someone has been seized by a cat-spirit, one should burn the skull-bone of a cat, mix the ash with clean earth, and fashion from the clay a likeness of the cat. Then, before a hollow-eyed image, one should consecrate a clean iron knife by reciting the mantra over it one hundred and eight times, cut the image into one hundred and eight pieces, reciting the mantra once while cutting and calling the name of the afflicted person once each time, and that person will be restored to lasting life.

If someone has been struck by a sorcery-spell, one should take equal parts of gugul and camphor, mix them with one measure of clean water drawn from a well, and boil the mixture. Taking what remains after boiling off the excess of about one ladle, one should consecrate it before a hollow-eyed image by reciting the mantra over it one hundred and eight times, and the person should drink it; they will recover.

If someone has been seized by a scorpion or a snake, one should consecrate powdered rhubarb by reciting the mantra seven times and apply it to the wound; they will instantly recover.

If wicked people have set a trap and caused harm, one should fashion a likeness of the adversary out of clean earth, dough, or butter, and place it before a hollow-eyed image. One should consecrate an iron knife by reciting the mantra one hundred and eight times, each time reciting the mantra once while stabbing it, calling the adversary by name, and after burning it, cut it into one hundred and eight pieces; that adversary will become joyful and will honor and love one with reverence for as long as they live.

For those who are afflicted by eye disease — whether the function of their eyes has deteriorated, become dim, become unclear, or been covered by white or red cataracts so that they have no light — one should finely grind one seed each of āmalaka, bibhīṭaka, and haritakī. During the preparation, one must observe purity: one should not be approached by a woman who has recently given birth, or by dogs and pigs. Invoking the name of the Tathāgata, one should combine the medicine with white honey and human milk and apply it to the eyes. That milk must be the milk of a mother who has given birth to a boy; the milk of a mother who has given birth to a girl is not suitable. After the compound medicine has been prepared, one should consecrate it before a hollow-eyed image by reciting the mantra one thousand and eight times, apply it to the eyes, and for seven days remain in a secluded room sheltered from the wind. The function of the eyes will be restored, and blue and white cataracts will be dispelled, making the vision clear and sharp.

For those who have been struck by spirits and become deranged, one should consecrate the skin of a tiger, a monkey, and a wolf by reciting the mantra twenty-one times over them and wrap it around the body; they will recover.

If someone has been bitten by a snake, one should take an ear-cloth from the person who was bitten, consecrate it by reciting the mantra twenty-one times, and press it against the wound; they will recover.

If, by means of a malicious sorcery-nail driven into the heart, someone is at the point of death, one should take a kapīṭha fruit roughly the size of a hand, combine it with one ladle of clean water, and —

boil it and give half of what remains; recite the mantra seven times over it and have the person drink it all at once — they will recover. This medicine should not be prepared in the presence of a woman.

If someone has fallen ill for a long time due to possession by a zombie spirit (ro lang), one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over guggul resin, burn it, and fumigate the nose with the smoke. Alternatively, one may take seven

pellets of dried rabbit dung, recite the mantra over them twenty-one times, and have the person swallow them; they will recover. During this treatment, one must abstain from meat, alcohol, the five pungent foods, and harsh speech.

Alternatively, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over a mixture of musk, white mustard seed, and rock salt, and burn it beneath the sick person's seat. The body of that possessing spirit will be destroyed, and unable to bear remaining, it will flee.

If half the body is paralyzed and the ear and nose become numb, or if the limbs cannot be drawn together, one should cook costus root in sesame oil, recite the mantra over it twenty-one times, and anoint the body with it — the person will recover completely. Alternatively, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over fresh butter and anoint the body with it; they will also recover.

If someone is having a difficult childbirth, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over sesame oil and anoint the navel and the birth canal of the pregnant woman — she will give birth quickly.

If a pregnant woman has a child that has died in the womb, one should take one srang weight of asafoetida and boil it in one cup of water; recite the mantra twenty-one times over half of what remains and have her drink it — the dead child will be expelled without pain or illness. If the afterbirth will not come out, drinking this same medicine will also be of benefit.

If a sudden stabbing pain arises in the chest that is unbearable, this is what is called the method of a zombie's piercing. One should recite the mantra twenty-one times over fresh, unground costus root and white chalk, give as much as is available, and have it swallowed — the person will recover. One must abstain from meat, alcohol, and the five pungent foods.

If someone has been burned by fire, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over warm fresh cow dung and apply it to the wound — they will recover.

If worms have entered the abdomen and the person is ill, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over half a cup of the urine of a white horse and have the person drink it — they will recover. In severe cases, if a full cup is drunk, the worms will emerge of their own accord, like a rope being pulled out.

If a severe anal fistula has developed, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over the expressed juice of pounded plantain, pour it over the fistula, and the root of the fistula will emerge on its own — the person will recover within a short time.

If a bee has entered the eye and the person is suffering, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over the expressed juice of squeezed donkey dung, and instill it into the eye at night — they will recover.

If there is abdominal pain, one should take twenty-one unground crystals of rock salt, put them into half a cup of pure well water, recite the mantra over them twenty-one times, and drink half of it — this will be of benefit.

If the eyes become inflamed, or if there is excessive growth of flesh in the eye, or if a pterygium has formed, one should pound and express the juice of the leaves of the chinaberry tree, recite the mantra seven times over it, then soak one hollow stalk of a dry thorny plant in it for one night, recite the mantra over it seven more times, and instill it into the eye — they will recover.

If at night, during the coming and going of spirits, a person becomes frightened and distressed, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over a white cord, make twenty-one knots in it, and tie it around the person's neck — they will be freed from fear and distress. Not only will they be freed from fear, but they will also gain merit and all their misdeeds will be purified.

If inauspicious omens appear around the home, one should take a branch of a Nepali *sī* tree, cut it into one thousand and eight pieces, anoint both ends with butter and yogurt, and recite the mantra once for each piece as it is burned, completing one thousand and eight in all. By doing so, all harmful spirits and obstructors will be thoroughly pacified. This, moreover, must be performed in the presence of a buddha image. Take a white mustard seed cord, instill the mantra into it one hundred and eight times, tie it to the right shoulder, and one will be victorious in all situations involving battle and the words of those who speak of fighting.

Take the leaves or a branch of a *keu khi tsé* tree — either will do — cut it into bundles of sprigs, anoint both ends with pure butter, white honey, and yogurt, and recite the mantra once while burning each piece in turn until one thousand and eight are complete. This is to be done three times a day on a single day, and at each session one thousand and eight recitations are performed. If one completes this for seven full days, the mantra practitioner will attain direct knowledge and perception.

If one wishes to tame a great and powerful demon, one should instill the mantra forty-nine times into a lū tang plant, coat it with molasses and honey, and burn it before an image of the noble one endowed with great compassion, Avalokiteśvara.

Place one sang weight of musk inside a vase of beryl, set it before the image of the noble one endowed with great compassion, instill the mantra one thousand and eight times, and then anoint the body with it or apply a drop to the forehead. All gods, nāgas, spirits, ghosts, humans, and non-humans will be greatly pleased.

If someone has been imprisoned, instill the mantra one hundred and eight times into the thick part of a white pigeon's quill feather, anoint the hand with it, and then smear it on the bonds and fetters — the bonds and fetters will release on their own.

If a husband and wife are incompatible, like water and fire, one should take a peacock's tail feather, instill the mantra one thousand and eight times before the image of the noble one endowed with great compassion, and tie it to their bodies — they will love and cherish each other all their lives.

If insects have entered and are devouring crops and fruit, take clean earth, ash, or sand, instill the mantra one thousand and eight times, and scatter it in the four directions of the field. The insects will disperse. Alternatively, instill the mantra into clean water and sprinkle it over the fruit-bearing trees — the insects will be unable to eat the fruit.

Namo Ratnatrayāya. Śara Mahāśara. Tulu Mahātulu. Oṃ Kume Haniśapa.

The Blessed One declared: If someone has traveled to a place where grain is scarce and famine has struck and food has run out, you should close your eyes, hold your body upright, concentrate your mind one-pointedly, recite this dhāraṇī one hundred and eight times, and then open your eyes. The gods will carry vessels filled with divine food of a hundred flavors and bring them to you.

If one is residing at home and needs food, place a clean empty vessel before you, close your eyes, fill your mouth with saliva, and scatter it over a willow branch, a fan, and a begging bowl. Having scattered the water, close your eyes and recite this dhāraṇī forty-nine times. Food of a hundred flavors will naturally fill every vessel of its own accord. Take it and store it for use over seven days. Know, then, that the power and strength of this dhāraṇī is

inconceivable.

After eating, close your eyes, say "Sara kha," and discard the leftovers. Even if one has eaten until full, the food will digest quickly, and one will gain strength and comfort, and will attain fearless eloquence.

Ānanda, this is the form for retaining what one has heard:

Namo buddhāya. Namō dharmāya. Namaḥ saṃghāya. Namō ādananiye. Uka ci du uka ci du. Matī lali. Lalute namitī nami svāhā.

One who holds this dhāraṇī should, at the summit of a mountain cut off from all four directions, draw a maṇḍala, establish a boundary, guard the body, and fill a small earthenware begging bowl with clean water from a spring. Place it before you, and recite the dhāraṇī mantra. Without fail, a brilliantly clear star will appear. When it appears, generate no fear; settle the mind in ease and equipoise, and recite the dhāraṇī mantra with one-pointed attention. The faculties will become sharp and one will be endowed with wisdom, so that there is nothing one does not know. There will be nothing whatsoever in the ways of the world's path that one fails to understand. When transmitting what one has heard, one should generate the perception that a supremely brilliant star is entering the water in the begging bowl.

The Great Compassion Dhāraṇī of the Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Unimpeded Lord, Vast and Perfectly Complete. Second Fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, joined his palms in reverence and addressed the Blessed One in these words:

Blessed One, through causes and conditions of merit I accumulated in the past — merit beyond conception — you, the Blessed One, have this day granted me a prophecy. And since I have aroused great compassion and wish to heal all sentient beings, to sever every bond of bondage, and to pacify all fears, I now desire to expound the dhāraṇī called "Mother." May the sentient beings of the final age, through the power of the blessing of hearing this dhāraṇī called "Mother," all be freed from the causes of suffering and thereby attain the fruit of happiness.

Blessed One, in the final five-hundred-year period, in whatever country, village, city, or township it may be, should a monk, a nun, a son of good family, or a daughter of good family, and others, regularly recite, chant, and uphold this doctrinal category of the dhāraṇī mantra called "Mother," doing so properly under a parasol six times — then I, in constant attendance,

remembering and attending to the kindness of the Tathāgata, will fully protect those persons and will not abandon them, and no malevolent spirit or demon will be able to harm them. Furthermore, all heavy obscurations accumulated over many lifetimes will be entirely purified at once, and all gates of the Dharma pertaining to the maṇḍalas of dhāraṇī mantras and to mudrās will swiftly be brought to perfect completion.

And once more he addressed the Blessed One, saying:

Blessed One, the sentient beings of the final five-hundred-year period will for the most part be thickly shrouded in the defilement of wrongdoing and will have little merit, yet even if there is someone who upholds this teaching, malevolent spirits and demons cause them harm. Therefore I now desire, through the blessing of the Blessed One, to greatly heal sentient beings, to bring happiness to sentient beings, and to expound the Dharma of the dhāraṇī for the sake of gods, asuras, and all others. For throughout as many past aeons as can be measured, I myself have relied upon and paid homage to this Dharma of the dhāraṇī. All the buddhas of the past, future, and present likewise have attained unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening by virtue of this doctrinal category of the dhāraṇī called "Mother." Therefore, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family recites and reads this doctrinal category of the dhāraṇī called "Mother" with one-pointed mind —

— they uphold and retain it, then in this very lifetime they will swiftly gain eloquence in speech, unimpeded and unobstructed, and will come to thoroughly realize wisdom and eloquence. Among the great retinues of gods and humans they will become supreme. Those who hear them will be filled with delight, and all will bow their heads and pay homage. In every birth they will behold the buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Whatever they say, all will listen with trust and confidence. All of this is by the power of the blessing of the blessed buddhas — it is not by one's own power alone.

Then the Blessed One praised the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, saying: "Excellent! Excellent! You have spoken thus for the benefit and happiness of all — gods, humans, asuras, and all the rest — and for the thorough purification of the path of karma." And he declared: "I too, having now sealed this with the mudrā of primordial wisdom, will ensure that you never turn away from sentient beings of all kinds through your great loving-kindness, great compassion, and the like."

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I recall — from across immeasurable past aeons — that when I was dwelling on Mount Potala, holding and upholding this doctrinal category of the dhāraṇī called 'Mother,' the king of māras, accompanied by a great host of māras, set out to disturb my Dharma practice and to prevent the syllables of the mantra from being accomplished. At that time, through this dhāraṇī called 'Mother,' I tamed the many māras and caused them all to disperse and go their separate ways. Thus should it be understood that the power of this dhāraṇī is inconceivable."

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, moved by loving-kindness and great compassion to benefit all sentient beings and to bring happiness to gods and humans, stood before the Blessed One and the great assembled retinue and, as Avalokiteśvara of the Thousand Hands and Thousand Eyes, recited the great dhāraṇī body of the one called "Mother":

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatāya. Namō ratna-trayāya. Namō Amitābhāya
tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Namō Āryāvalokiteśvarāya
bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Namō Mahāsthāmaprāptāya
bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Namō
vipula-vimāna-supraṭiṣṭhita-saṃghāya.

Sūrya-śata-sahasra-atireka-prabhā-avabhāṣita-mūrtaye.

Mahā-maṇi-mukūṭa-kunḍala-alaṃkāra-dhāraṇī. Bhagavate padma-pāṇaye.
Sarva-loka-upaśamanāya.

Vividha-mukha-samāveśa-viṣṭa-sarva-sattva-parimocakāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ
bhūr bhuvaḥ. Mahā-loka-karaṇa. Nātha-ma-siddhe
mira-bhadrā-vināśana-kārāya

rāga-dveṣa-moha-jvala-śamaka-śa-saka-samāśvāsana-kara-ka

sarva-pāpa-durgati-praśamana-kārāya. Sarva-tathāgata-sambandana-kara he
he mahā-bodhisattva vara-da padma-loki-saṃbhūta mahākāruṇika
jaṭā-mukūṭa-alaṃkāra-śarīraṃ. Maṇi-kanaka-śata.

Vajra-vaiḍūrya-alaṃkāra-śarīra. Amitābha-śikha-mālā-alaṃkāra-prabhā-raṇa.

Larī-cana mahā-duna. Na-ran-ri-śata-sa-śasra. Abhilāṣita-kāya.

Mahā-bodhisattvāya. Vidhama vidhama. Vināśaya vināśaya. Mahā-yantraṃ
kleśa-kavāḍha. Avabandha-vividha-sattva-saṃsāra-cāraka. Pramathanā.

Puruṣa-padma-puruṣa-nāga. Puruṣa-sāgara. Puruṣa-siṃha.

vīra vīrāśaya. suyanta suyanta. bara bara. dhama dhama. sama sama. dhuru
dhuru. praśāsaya praśāsaya. giri gira. biri biri. ciri ciri. muru muru. muyu
muyu. muya muya. muñca muñca. dhuna dhuna. vidhuna vidhuna. dhuru

dhuru. gāya gāya. gādhaya gādhaya. hasa hasa. prahasa prahasa. vibhidha-kleśa-vāsana. For the person named so-and-so: hara hara. saṃhara saṃhara. duruṭi duruṭi. mahāmantra-duruṭi. karṇa-śata-parsika-bhava-visana. śamaka mahābodhisattva varada svāhā.

At that very moment, as soon as the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara had recited before the Blessed One this dhāraṇī called "the Mother of the Precious Array of the Great Lotus," the trichiliocosm — the great world-system of three thousand times three thousand worlds — quaked in six ways from the lowest realms up to the divine abode of neither-perception-nor-non-perception, and it quaked greatly and thoroughly. The gods also rained down a shower of precious flowers. The gods of Akaniṣṭha and the great lords of gods (Śiva) too were seized by agitation and discomfort, and they became deeply afraid and terrified. All the yakṣas, rākṣasas, malevolent demons, and harmful spirits were expelled with a great cry uttering the sound of great suffering, and they fled in all directions, east and west, yet found and obtained no place to go.

Then the emanated bodhisattva spoke to the vast retinue and to all the malevolent demons and harmful spirits, saying: "Whoever does not submit to and follow along with my vidyā-mantra, all the limbs, major and minor, of their bodies shall utterly ache and be destroyed. This vidyā-mantra shatters mountains and dries up the great ocean. It utterly defeats and vanquishes the armies of the asuras. It completely protects the surrounding regions, villages, towns, and cities. It defeats and thoroughly pacifies malevolent demons, illness, poisonous medicines, insect venoms, the perverse, and malevolent persons. It tames and thoroughly disciplines the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three."

When he had said this, the Blessed One, dwelling in the supremely joyous palace of the Great Vajra, and the most excellent and venerable bodhisattvas, and all the immeasurable retinue of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, kiṃnaras, and the rest — all of them who abide in the Dharma of the buddhas — simultaneously raised their voices in praise.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, since this vidyā-mantra utterly shatters even the most vast and towering mountains of obscuration, whoever hears it, reads it, recites it, retains it, or comes to see it — all the dark afflictive obscurations they have, every last one, shall be purified and cleared away. Furthermore,

whoever habitually rises early and, with a reverent mind, reads or recites this Mother's dhāraṇī twenty-one times, Avalokiteśvara himself will constantly follow after them, fully protecting and completely safeguarding them. Whoever wishes to swiftly accomplish all the vast gateways of aspiration and meditative absorption should go to a solitary dwelling place, recollect the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara in mind,

keeping one's mind undistracted by anything else, and constantly reciting this dhāraṇī one hundred and eight times — there is not a single aspiration that will fail to be accomplished. Furthermore, one will become dear to the hearts of all sentient beings, and one will not fall into any of the gates of the lower destinies. Whether or not one is present in a particular place, if one cultivates and maintains the perception that one is always dwelling before the buddhas, then all the sinful karma one has accumulated throughout birth-places beyond measure — countless tens of millions — will be entirely dissolved and purified. That person will come to enjoy the full splendor of merit equal to that of a thousand wheel-turning kings. In every lifetime one will be born simultaneously with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. One will be born into noble and virtuous households.

If anyone constantly scatters before the form of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara whatever handful of incense or flowers they may have, and recites this dhāraṇī twenty-one times, they will attain the qualities of the world-realm of the great thousand-fold universe and will attain the nature of reality (dharmatā) of great compassion. That person will swiftly and directly accomplish great power in the world.

If anyone constantly gazes upon the face, eyes, major marks, and excellent features of the bodhisattva, and recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara will swiftly manifest his body directly and visibly, so that the yogin will behold him. Being thereby freed from defilement, one will attain the first ground and the meditative absorption (samādhi) that recollects the buddhas, and by that will illuminate world-realms with light. At the time of death one will die as though entering into dhyāna and meditative absorption, and in all future lives will attain the wisdom of recollecting one's previous abodes. All blameworthy and sinful deeds, whatever they may be, will likewise be dissolved and purified.

Whoever wishes to fully uphold this dhāraṇī should constantly observe — during the spring month of the hare, the middle summer month, and the last

autumn month — the restoration and confession ceremony (poṣadha), dwelling in moral discipline, wearing clean white robes, taking the three white foods, and then before a stūpa containing relics, or before relics themselves, making a square maṇḍala one cubit in size from white sandalwood paste. Scatter various flowers and incenses within the maṇḍala, burn incense before the image of a Tathāgata, fill the lamps with ghee, and with a mind of reverence toward the buddhas and bodhisattvas, constantly recite this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times — from the first to the tenth day of those months. Then on the night of the fifteenth day, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara himself will come into the maṇḍala, and the moment the yogin sees him, all obscurations of the five heinous sins of immediate retribution (ānantarya), however heavy they may be, will be dissolved and purified, all actions of body, speech, and mind will be completely purified, and one will also attain the power of the buddhas' meditative absorption, the power of the ground of empowerment, the power of the ground of the perfections, and especially the supremely exalted gnosis.

Blessed One, if anyone should wish to cause rain to fall from the sky, let them look up into the sky and recite this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times — and rain will fall in timely showers of the finest quality.

If one looks at a drought-stricken field and recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times in full, all manner of grains will flourish well.

If one goes to the bank of a dried-up river or spring and recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times, the waters will increase and flow abundantly.

Before all those afflicted by the illness of salt-craving, one should intone this mantra seven times over one's own right hand and then stroke them with that hand — and they will be healed.

Before one whose mindfulness has deteriorated, if one recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times, perfect mindfulness will be attained.

Before those endangered by hunger and thirst, if one looks upon their faces and recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times, all unwholesome perceptions born of hunger and thirst will be thoroughly removed.

If one wishes to consecrate a boundary, one should enter a pond or body of water and properly write out this dhāraṇī in full according to the Dharma, then affix it to the tip of a victory banner — and within a range of one hundred leagues there will be no harmful spirits or obstructors whatsoever; the

boundary will be sealed and all within will be thoroughly protected.

Whatever son or daughter of good family continually recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times as if holding a single parasol above them — the merit of such a person is beyond all telling, and those holders of the vidyā-mantra will become venerable and endowed with authority. Moreover, they will be loved and honored by a great multitude of people, and all their aspirations will be fulfilled just as they wish.

If one wishes to subdue māras, one should recite this dhāraṇī of the Mother, consecrate guggula resin twenty-one times with the mantra, and then, reciting the mantra once and burning one portion at a time, complete one hundred and eight repetitions in all — and the māras will be thoroughly banished.

If one wishes all the many people around one to be joyful, one should continually consecrate the tip of a willow branch twenty-one times with the mantra, then place it at the entrance of the house — and all will love and honor one.

If one wishes to become endowed with eloquence and wisdom oneself, one should take one sraṅga of white aconite powder, mix it with butter, milk, and honey, and form it into pills. Then, with this dhāraṇī of the Mother, one should apply the mantra continuously until these three signs appear: heat, then smoke, then light. Having obtained those signs, one should take seven pills at a time, once each day, and also anoint the heart-center with them. If one does this continuously for one hundred days, one will attain unobstructed eloquence. Then, for the protection of one's own body, one should daily recite this dhāraṇī of the Mother one hundred and eight times and also perform the twelve mudrās.

The first of these is the mudrā of the all-gathering body of the bodhisattva possessed of a thousand eyes, and it is as follows. Rise and stand upright, hold the body straight, place the two feet together, and curve the right foot slightly inward. Then extend the left forearm downward, bend the ring finger and little finger into the palm and rest them there, while the small finger, index finger, and thumb are extended straight; cup the palm and turn it facing upward. After that, do the same with the right forearm, but bend the middle finger and bring it level with the shoulder, with the palm facing forward. This is called the mudrā of the all-gathering body.

If one wishes to crush the dense thicket of wrong views held by māras and non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and lead them onto the right path, one should

perform this mudrā and recite the mantra twenty-one times — and without fail it will be accomplished just as one has aspired.

The dhāraṇī is as follows: Namo ratnatrayāya. Nama āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: avaṭṭa avaṭṭa parivatte ehi ehi svāhā.

Now, the second of these — the mudrā of the dhāraṇī of all-gathering belonging to the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes — is as follows. Just as in the previous mudrā of the all-gathering body, join the palms together and place them at the heart, then interlace all five fingers and turn them downward, with the left pressing upon the right. Extend both index fingers straight upward so that their tips meet, and press both thumbs against the first joint of the two index fingers, separating them slightly. This is called the mudrā of the dhāraṇī of all-gathering.

If one performs this mudrā, all the sinful karma accumulated throughout saṃsāra over immeasurable aeons will be purified entirely and all at once. In future lifetimes one will be reborn in the utterly pure buddha-fields of the buddhas of the ten directions.

When the Blessed One Śākyamuni was close to attaining perfect and complete awakening, the king of māras sought an opportunity to intervene — yet by performing this mudrā of the dhāraṇī of all-gathering, he attained dhyāna and meditative absorption of the most sublime ease.

The dhāraṇī is as follows: Tadyathā: sarvadhāraṇīmaṇḍala ehi ehi prabhāśuddhasattvāya svāhā.

Now, the third — the mudrā of liberation, dhyāna, and meditative absorption belonging to the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes — is as follows. Drape the outer robe over one shoulder, place the knee of the right leg on the ground, join the palms at the crown of the head, bend both index fingers so that their tips touch, and press both thumbs upon the second joint of the index fingers. This Dharma mudrā is called the mudrā of liberation, dhyāna, and meditative absorption.

All Tathāgatas of the past, too, achieved dhyāna, meditative absorption, and liberation by accomplishing this very Dharma. The vidyā mantra for this mudrā is the same as the one given before.

If someone performs this mudrā and makes offerings each day, as regularly as the turns of an umbrella, they will swiftly come to behold the buddhas of the

ten directions.

Now, the fourth — the mudrā of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes — is as follows. Stand upright with both feet together. As before, place the middle fingers, ring fingers, and little fingers back to back, extend both index fingers straight upward so that their tips touch, and press both thumbs upon the second joints of the index fingers. Hold the hands apart by the width of five finger-breadths and place them at the level of the brow. This is called the mudrā of the one endowed with a thousand eyes.

If one performs this Dharma-gate of the mudrā, one will behold a hundred million excellent, utterly pure world-systems — buddha-fields — and from each and every one of those buddha-fields, fourteen hundred thousand bodhisattvas will come to accompany that yogin as companions.

Those who have not entered the Dharma-gate of the maṇḍala even three times should neither look upon this Dharma-gate of the mudrā nor perform this rite.

For a bodhisattva who has seen the signs and who possesses even a single clear Dharma-wisdom supernormal cognition (abhijñā), whatever and however many things one aspires to will all be perfectly fulfilled.

The dhāraṇī is as follows: Oṃ sarvacakṣuḥkārāyadhāraṇīindrāya svāhā.

Now, the fifth — the mudrā of the thousand-handed all-gathering belonging to the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes — is as follows. Stand upright, bring the feet together,

first, fill the palm of the right hand and bring the five fingers together one by one in sequence. After that, press the fist of the left palm upon the right and place it at the heart. This is called the mudrā of the thousand-handed all-gathering. With this mudrā, all the māras that exist throughout the great trichiliocosm are gathered and subdued. The dhāraṇī is as follows: Tadyathā: Avalokiteśvarāya, sarvaduṣṭa ohāyani svāhā.

Now, the sixth — the mudrā by which the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes attains meditative absorption (samādhi) — is as follows. Stand upright, bring the feet together, then first extend the fingers of the left hand into a fist, bend the middle finger, and extend it forward. After that, do the same with the right hand, bend the middle finger, and extend it inward facing. This is called the mudrā by which meditative absorption is attained. Through this mudrā, one attains meditative absorption, the array of the mudrās of

gnosis, and the eighty-four thousand Dharma-gates; and one will also actualize unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. The vidyā mantra to be recited is the same as before.

Now, the seventh — the mudrā of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes for summoning and gathering the eight classes of gods and nāgas and the hosts of spirits and demons — is as follows. Stand upright, cross the two feet, then first touch the thumbnail with the little finger of the left hand; after that do the same with the right hand; then extend the little finger and middle finger straight upright so that their tips meet, join the two knuckles of the ring fingers, and let the index fingers intertwine. The vidyā mantra is as follows: Oṃ sarva deva nāga anari svāhā.

Now, the eighth — the mudrā of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes for summoning the Great Brahmā and Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) and requesting the Dharma — is as follows. Upon the preceding mudrā, open the two knuckles of the ring fingers, bring the edges of the fists together, hollow the palms, and let the index fingers intertwine. The vidyā mantra is as follows: Oṃ mahābrahmāya ehi ehi svāhā. Through this mudrā and vidyā mantra, all the Dharma-gates of the mudrās of dhāraṇī — limitless and innumerable — are perfectly gathered and assembled.

If the sun or the moon undergoes an eclipse, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over butter, or alternatively recite the mantra twenty-one times. If one anoints oneself with the butter consecrated by the mudrā and sealed, the faculties become sharp, and one will master ten thousand verses in a single sitting.

This Dharma-gate of the mudrā was declared by the Tathāgata Sūryagarbha to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara.

Now, the ninth — the mudrā of the wish-fulfilling jewel of exceeding joy of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes — is as follows. Stand upright, join the palms at the heart, bend both thumbs into the palms, extend the other four fingers straight, place the palms joined at the heart, and recite the preceding vidyā mantra. Without fail, one will gain entry into the celestial palaces of the gods, travel through the buddha-fields of the buddhas of the ten directions, obtain eight thousand precious jewels just as one has wished, and make offerings to the buddhas.

As for one who wishes to accomplish this Dharma-gate: on the following morning, rise early, bathe and purify oneself completely, and then perform this

mudrā. One will directly behold the buddhas of the ten directions as numerous as the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā River,

all the heavy misdeeds and transgressions of wrongful karma accumulated throughout as many eons as there are moments will be completely purified. It is for this reason that praises of such qualities are proclaimed.

The tenth is the mudrā of the bodhisattva of a thousand eyes by which all aspirations are fulfilled as wished. Starting from the preceding mudrā, bend the two index fingers and press the nails of the two thumbs against them, so that the nails of the index fingers face outward. Recite the same vidyā mantra as before. Performing this will cause all aspirations to be fulfilled, and without fail one will never turn back from the path to awakening.

The eleventh is the mudrā of the meditative absorption of cessation of the bodhisattva of a thousand eyes. Starting from the preceding mudrā, extend all five fingers straight and separate the palms. This mudrā was granted to me by the buddhas as numerous as the grains of sand in the Gaṅgā River when I was formerly abiding on the causal ground, whereby the path to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening became directly manifest for me. Recite the same vidyā mantra as before.

The twelfth is the mudrā of the meditative absorption for inviting the buddhas of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes. Starting from the preceding mudrā, join the palms at the heart and interweave the two index fingers. The vidyā mantra is as follows: Oṃ sarva-buddha-samaya ehi ehi brahmaśuddhasatva svāhā.

Regarding the rite for drawing the maṇḍala of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes and a thousand hands: this Dharma of the maṇḍala, vidyā mantra, and mudrā of the Mother endowed with great miraculous powers — in the final age, it causes all holders of the vidyā mantra to swiftly and clearly behold the maṇḍala of the samādhi of the dhāraṇī mantra equal to the vidyā mantra of the Tathāgata. Therefore, whatever person holds the vidyā mantra must always keep their speech restrained and must not speak idle words. Whatever miraculous powers arisen from dhāraṇī, whatever meditative absorptions, and whatever signs and portents of various kinds — these must not be transmitted carelessly and without examination. With a mind of complete faith, keeping mindfulness close at hand, one must not be distracted even for a single moment.

If one were, out of greed and deception, to display to others different signs in a spirit of rivalry, then even though one seeks to purify evil karma, those purifications will not be accomplished. And if one does not cultivate with genuine, pure, and correct Dharmic intention, whatever has been done will amount to nothing but a confession of futility and mere experience of various kinds of suffering — and no accomplishments whatsoever will be fully achieved. Therefore, always guarding with diligent effort the complete purity of moral discipline, one must not seek the five kinds of pungent foods or flesh and alcohol.

If divisive speech, deceitful speech, or words born of jealousy should occur, or if the fault of stealing the rites of the maṇḍala, mudrā, and vidyā mantra should arise, all the buddhas and bodhisattvas will abandon such a person. They will declare: "Although I have not cast you out, you are not fit to be looked upon and taken into care." Blessed One, such persons demolish the completely pure moral discipline of all the Tathāgatas, and they defame and destroy the Three Jewels, the true Dharma, and all that bears the mark of virtue. Such persons are perpetually accompanied by the māras who are sons of gods,

and with all malevolent spirits, tīrthikas, and vināyakas. They are gathered into a single realm, fixed in a single deed, and rendered forever without refuge. Know that the noble ones will not fully protect them, and that they will be perpetually censured by all buddhas, bodhisattvas, noble ones, gods, and sages.

Know this to be so: for persons such as these, who undermine the path and destroy the Dharma, even if they should hold this dhāraṇī in mind as their constant companion and symbol, I, the Blessed One, see that it will never come to be accomplished for them. Nor is that failure of accomplishment a fault on my part; the fault and the flaw lie with those persons themselves. For that reason I shall neither look upon nor listen to the rite of this dhāraṇī or those texts of it. Nor shall I bestow it to be recited and held.

Those, however, who guard the purity of their holy conduct completely, who possess a mind of loving-kindness and compassion, who cherish sentient beings with heartfelt love and who devote themselves to accomplishing awakening — if such persons write it down, read it, recite it, and fully retain it, the maṇḍala of the dhāraṇī of the Mother will be fully accomplished for them.

This Dharma rite is the supreme secret heart-essence of the bodhisattva, the great being, the Lord Avalokiteśvara. Therefore, one who holds the vidyā mantra should, with a sincere mind and a mind of diligence, fully relinquish the limbs and secondary limbs of the body, the bones, the flesh, the sinews and channels, the feet, the head, the eyes, and so forth, and offer them to others. Having wholly devoted oneself to this Dharma, one should always strive to accomplish it with earnest and diligent effort. If one does so, then to give jewels, grain, fine silks, robes, bedding, medicines, and wealth and goods of every variety for the sake of the Dharma of the images of the dhāraṇī of the liberating Mother, the maṇḍala, and the mudrā — what need is there even to speak of that? One should accomplish it with single-pointed mind, just as the ācārya has taught.

Why is this so? Because this Dharma of the dhāraṇī of liberation, in the final age at the end of time, performs the deeds of the buddhas for sentient beings, and brings to full accomplishment right conduct, the ultimate end of right action, right diligence, and the direction traversed by right view, and the path of liberation. From this very moment it causes them never to turn back until they fully awaken to unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening.

As for the maṇḍala itself, it may be set up inside a temple, or on a mountain, or beside a flowing stream, or at the edge of a forest. In the surrounding area, to a distance of one cubit in all directions, one should dig out and clear away whatever may be present — roots of trees, inauspicious rocks, mounds of earth, lumps of soil, bones, and the like. Then from a spot of excellent clean earth one should take soil to a depth of one cubit, pound it, and level it smooth. One should mix it with cow dung, fragrant water, and yellow earth to make a plaster, apply it well, smooth it completely, and then divide it into five sections.

The central section should be made three cubits across, and exactly in its center one should draw a jewel wheel, half a cubit square, with one hundred and eight spokes. Furthermore, within the center of that wheel one should draw an open jewel lotus with thirty-two petals, one cubit in size. Furthermore, along the outermost rim of the wheel one should draw blazing light rays. After that, on each of the four corners of the section one should draw a single open lotus. And furthermore, on top of each lotus one should draw a single wish-fulfilling jewel, and on top of those four jewels one should draw blazing light rays.

Furthermore, on top of that lotus with thirty-two petals one should place an image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara fashioned from white sandalwood. Then the second section is to be made one cubit across, and on it, as before, one should draw a single open lotus on each of the four corners. Furthermore, on top of each of those lotuses one should draw three tiered thrones of Mount Meru, and on the throne at the north-east corner one should draw the deity of the Great Lord; on the throne at the south-east corner one should draw the deity of Great Power; on the throne at the south-west corner one should draw Great Brahmā; and on the throne at the north-west corner one should draw Śakra, the Hundred-Powered One. Furthermore, on all four sides one should draw sixteen garlands of jeweled flowers.

Then the third section is to be made one and a half cubits across, and on it, on a blue ground, one should draw only lines of gold.

Then the fourth section is to be made one cubit across. On all four sides in total one should mark out twenty-eight intervals, and within each of those individual intervals one should draw a single open lotus. Furthermore, in due order, on top of each of those lotuses one should individually draw: the mudrā of the vajra hammer; the mudrā of the three-pointed symbol; the mudrā of the enemy-stand; the mudrā of the knife; the mudrā of the sword; the mudrā of the conch; the mudrā of the water-knife; the mudrā of the lasso; the mudrā of the one holding a staff; the mudrā of the parasol; the mudrā of the wish-fulfilling jewel; the mudrā of the staff of the Lord of Death; the mudrā of Vināyaka; the mudrā of the weapon; the mudrā of the wheel; and the mudrā of the trunk with its various hands. And on all of those mudrās one should further draw blazing rays of light.

Furthermore, within the interval drawn at the southern water-gate one should draw the deity free from conflict. Within the interval drawn at the western water-gate one should draw the water deity. Within the interval drawn at the northern water-gate one should draw Kubera. Within the interval drawn at the eastern water-gate one should draw the youthful deity.

Then, at each of the four corner positions, one should draw the four Great Kings with wrathful expressions, together with their retinues.

Then the fifth section is to be made one cubit across, and on all four sides one should draw various fruit-bearing trees, flowering trees, and jewel trees of many kinds. Furthermore, at each of the four corners one should draw a single jeweled Mount Meru. At the four water-gates one should draw the waters of

the great ocean. The ground of the inner sections of the maṇḍala is to be rendered in blue. Furthermore, on the southern side of the western water-gate of those inner sections, one should open a single gate through which the mantra-practitioner may enter and depart.

Furthermore, a single image of Avalokiteśvara with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands is to be made, and placed in the center facing east. Furthermore, a single volume of the sūtra with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands is to be set atop a lotus with thirty-two petals, and before that image one should place: sixteen vials of white sandalwood-scented water; twenty-five bowls filled with various foods, the three white foods, fruits, and so forth; a measure of incense-water; twenty-five vases adorned at their mouths with various colored silks, flowers, and branches of trees; twenty of each of various kinds of flowers and garlands; twenty-eight lamps; incense paste, powdered incense, and twenty sticks of other such incense;

twenty-five banner-streamers painted with images of bodhisattvas, and twenty-five banner-streamers made from various colored silks, arranged all around. All the vessels, implements, vases, and other utensils used in making these offerings should be fashioned from gold, silver, copper, or similar metals. If those are not available, replicas will also do. All these materials and implements are to be drawn and arranged properly on the four sides of the inner islands according to the rite. Cushions and flowers of various kinds and forms are to be scattered about. Rice, sālu flowers, white mustard seed, and flowers of many varieties are to be scattered upon the maṇḍala. The food offerings should be freshly prepared and of excellent quality, offered under a single canopy. The mantrin, when entering the ritual, should bathe and purify himself completely, anoint himself with perfumed incense paste, and dress in clean, fresh clothing. He should partake of the three white foods and then, mixing together sandalwood, aloe wood, bdellium resin, camphor, and the like, he should make offerings three times a day under a single canopy to the image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the Sovereign with a Thousand Eyes and a Thousand Hands. Before the image of the Thousand-Eyed One placed within the third inner island, he should make a firm resolve to properly take upon himself all three bodhisattva vows. Then, at the time of the canopy sign, he should proceed to the water-door on the western side of the outer island, sit cross-legged, and, without interruption, recite the dhāraṇī of the Mother one thousand and eight times under a single canopy, directing his intention throughout all twenty-one canopies as an offering. Furthermore, at each of the

six sessions of the day, he should enter the maṇḍala through the water-door at the western corner of the maṇḍala, stand at the water-door on the western side of the third island, and perform all the mudrās that were previously taught — from the first and second through to the third, and on through the twelfth, the meditative absorption of invoking the buddhas — reciting the mantra seven times for each. Having completed up to the twelfth mudrā, he should make this aspiration: "May I myself, manifestly and irrevocably, be established in the most excellent aspiration for great and perfect awakening," and then, having made that aspirational prayer, he should draw the assembly in. When this is done, all will draw near. He should then stand upright in body, come forward with firm, certain mind, and cultivate the perception that all gods and spirits are present and assembled before him, with no offering absent. Without directing attention toward any separate or external object, he should recite the earlier great body mantra twenty-one times. On that very night, great rays of light will issue forth from the image, and the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara himself will without fail appear in person, manifesting his body in visible form. When he appears and comes forth, he will manifest in a joyful physical form of great beauty, and with a smiling and delighted countenance he will ask the yogin: "What is it that you need? What do you wish for?" At that moment, the mantrin should reply as follows: "I seek unsurpassed and perfectly complete awakening, the Dharma of dhāraṇī and meditative absorption in its fullness, and furthermore the accomplishment of all the rites of the maṇḍala, mudrās, and mantras, and the subjugation of all harmful spirits and demons so that they become obedient to my word." Having thus made his requests and seen them fulfilled, he should keep this knowledge to himself and not speak of it to others. This maṇḍala rite may also be performed by drawing the design on woolen cloth or woven fabric.

If one wishes for all aspirations to be fulfilled, one should make a square water maṇḍala and burn aloeswood incense. Then, having recited the earlier mantra of Mahākāya one thousand and eight times, one should perform the earlier mudrā of wish-granting fulfillment of aspirations for the tenth section. All aspirations will thereby be fulfilled and brought to perfect completion just as one has wished.

If one wishes for all people, in great numbers, to become joyful, one should first perform the earlier mudrā of the wish-fulfilling jewel of supreme joy, and then apply the mantra of Mahākāya to sesame seeds twenty-one times. Alternatively, one may recite the mantra once, toss one seed at a time into the

fire — completing one thousand and eight in all — and by this means all will be made joyful according to one's wish.

If one wishes for the yakṣas to become joyful, one should take a branch from the tree of the pleasure grove of the yakṣas, apply the mantra to it twenty-one times, and throw it into the pleasure grove; they will be made joyful thereby.

If one wishes to tame a wicked person who has become an enemy, one should apply the mantra twenty-one times to a hollow piece of wood, then recite the mantra once and throw one piece of wood at a time, completing one hundred and eight in all. The person will come to take refuge and be tamed.

If there is a spirit or demon that is difficult to subdue, one should apply the mantra twenty-one times to bdellium resin and white mustard seed, then recite the mantra once and throw one portion at a time, completing one hundred and eight in all. All spirits and demons will thereby be spontaneously tamed.

If an epidemic disease arises in a region, one should make a square water maṇḍala, apply the mantra one hundred and eight times to fine butter, recite the mantra once and cast one portion at a time into the fire, completing one thousand and eight in all. All epidemic diseases will be pacified. Alternatively, one may take a small amount of water and give it to those struck by the epidemic to drink, and they will recover immediately.

In former times, in a region called Geyin, an epidemic arose, and all those afflicted by it would die within one or two days without exception. At that time, a brahmin named Cinti gave rise to great compassion, arrayed this ritual method, and healed all those afflicted by the epidemic throughout an entire region, so that everything was pacified. The king of the spirits and demons who sends plagues also departed from the region at that time; and for this reason, know that the offering of medicine is of great importance.

If one is threatened by the forces of an enemy army, or if there are bandits or conflicts, one should perform the first mudrā of gathering all bodies, and recite the vidyā-mantra one hundred and eight times. All those enemies and bandits will thereby be thoroughly pacified of their own accord.

If a son or daughter of good family, through the power of karmic maturation, is approaching the obstruction of a premature death in the course of their lives, one should perform the earlier mudrā for the absorption of cessation of near death, make offerings every single day, burn aloeswood, recite the

vidyā-mantra one thousand and eight times, and then — reciting the mantra once and invoking the person by name once each time — the karmic obscurations will be entirely purified.

In former times, in the city of Vārāṇasī, there lived a householder who had only one son. That son was unable to survive past the age of sixteen, and when he reached the age of fifteen, the householder fell into a state of wasting grief and misery. At that time, a brahmin who was wandering from door to door begging for food saw the householder and asked: "Why are you in such distress?" The householder explained the whole story in detail. The brahmin then said to the householder: "Do not grieve. Do exactly as I instruct you."

"Your son will live long," he said. Then that brahmin performed this very rite for a full seven days, after which the Lord of Death spoke to that householder: "Because the measure of your son's life could not exceed sixteen years, he had reached fifteen and had no more than one year remaining. But today, having encountered a virtuous condition, he will be able to live a full hundred years. It is for this reason that I have come here to inform you." Upon hearing this, the householder was overjoyed and filled with delight, and he gathered up all the wealth of his household and offered it to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Know therefore that this rite possesses inconceivably great power.

Furthermore, one who has previously entered the great assembly maṇḍala and the great vajra maṇḍala three times need not seek out a maṇḍala. Simply by performing the mudrā and reciting the vidyā-mantra, there is nothing among one's aspirations that will go unfulfilled, and one will swiftly attain complete and perfect awakening.

If any woman undergoes great suffering at the time of giving birth, let the mantra-holder recite the mantra twenty-one times over water and give it to her to drink; she will surely be at ease. And whatever boys or girls are born will be endowed with excellent marks and features. Adorned with various virtues and empowered by previously accumulated merit, they will become dear to the hearts of many people. Continuously, in the human realm, they will enjoy supremely excellent enjoyments.

If any sentient being is afflicted by eye disease and suffers in pain and discomfort, let the mantra-holder form the mudrā of the bodhisattva possessed of a thousand eyes, recite the mantra twenty-one times, and apply the mudrā to the eyes; the eyes will be healed. Through that cause and

condition, that person will obtain a divine eye, will clearly see the gods, and will enjoy the highest enjoyments.

The rite for painting the image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the Lord with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands, is as follows. The canvas of white cloth should be sixteen cubits or alternatively twenty cubits. The body of that bodhisattva is to be rendered in the color of Jambu-river gold. On the face are three eyes. He is endowed with a thousand auxiliary hands, and in the palm of each of those thousand auxiliary hands draw one eye. The primary great hands are eighteen in number. The first two hands join the palms together at the chest in añjali. One hand holds a vajra hammer. Another holds a trident. Another holds a book. Another holds a precious seal. Another holds a ringing staff. Another holds a precious jewel. Another holds a precious wheel. Another holds a full-blown lotus. Another holds a lasso. Another holds a willow branch. Another causes rays of five-colored light to issue forth. Another holds a rosary. Another holds a ball. Another is shown as the hand that wholly releases a sweet, fragrant breeze. Another is shown as the fearless hand that rains down various precious substances. Two more are present with the left pressing upon the right, palms filled and flat, at the level of the navel. All the remaining nine hundred and ninety-two hands are emanated auxiliary hands, and each of those hands individually holds various weapons and mudrās of different kinds. Some of these are shown with the auxiliary hand extending the mudrā of midday. Since these vary individually, the root sūtra states:

As it is said: "That bodhisattva wears a crown ornament of seven divine precious substances upon his head. His wrists are adorned with various kinds of ring bracelets. Upon his body he wears garlands and is clothed in exquisite garments of divine precious material." Such is the statement found there.

Among those pigments, lacquer shall not be used as a gift medium. They shall be mixed with gum resin solution. For those who wish to perform the ritual of the Mother's dhāraṇī, first draw the image of that form in a painting. And in drawing that image, it must indeed be done in proper accordance with the Dharma. Therefore, throughout the entire area surrounding the painting studio, sprinkle and anoint with white sandalwood water, and construct a maṇḍala. Furthermore, when the painter enters and takes up the work, he must first bathe, put on clean new garments, and each day take up the eight vows in their entirety. Once the image has been correctly painted in accordance with the Dharma, but if one suspects that the painter did not proceed in proper accordance with the Dharma, then make a square maṇḍala

as envisioned in the mind, and spread it abundantly with pennants, flowers, food offerings, the three white foods, flowers, garlands, perfumed water, and various flowers, making extensive offerings. Then the yogin and whoever the painter may be shall, before the completed painting, confess and acknowledge all transgressions over the course of twenty-one full days. At the completion of twenty-one nights, great rays of light shall issue forth from the painted image of the one possessed of a thousand eyes and a thousand hands, outshining sun and moon. With that light, all the world-realms of the great trichiliocosm in the ten directions, as far as they extend and have measure, shall be illuminated without obstruction. Whatever heavy transgressions exist for the yogin and the painter, and for all sentient beings touched by that light, shall all be simultaneously dissolved and completely purified. The only exception is one who has not applied one-pointed attention in accomplishing this rite.

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara then spoke again in these words: "In former times, the Tathāgata Viśvadarśin also displayed these thousand hands and thousand eyes and thereby was seen to tame the great māras. Blessed One, now I too, by displaying these thousand hands and thousand eyes, have tamed the great māras. Each of those palm hands shall individually manifest as a wheel-turning king, and shall become wheel-turning kings throughout a thousand excellent aeons. Each of those thousand eyes shall individually manifest as a buddha, and shall arise as equal in number to the thousand buddhas of the fortunate aeon. Thus, Blessed One, among all bodies that tame māras, that bodhisattva's body is supreme."

Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara: "Excellent! Excellent! By the power of blessing, I too shall consecrate this dhāraṇī of your Mother until the end of all aeons."

The Dhāraṇī of the Vast and Complete Great Compassion of the Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the Unobstructed — the Third Fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, having heard the Blessed One speak words of praise, was filled with great joy and delight. He joined his palms together, gazed up at the face of the Blessed One, and spoke these words: "Blessed One, there is furthermore a seal-gesture of the form with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands that I wish to accomplish."

The Blessed One declared, "I too rejoice and approve. Please, speak it."

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke, and as he recited this dhāraṇī spell, every divine realm throughout the great trichiliocosm — from the lowest

to the highest, up to the sphere of neither-perception-nor-non-perception — trembled and quaked in six ways. The gods of the Akaniṣṭha heaven and the Great God (Śiva) were seized with extreme fear and discomfort. All malevolent spirits and demons experienced tremendous suffering; they cried out in anguish and fled to east and west, unable to find any place of refuge. Then, by means of an emanated body, Avalokiteśvara addressed the vast retinue and all the malevolent spirits and demons, commanding them: "If you do not follow this dhāraṇī spell of mine, if you act in opposition to it, your heads shall be split into seven pieces."

"Blessed One, this dhāraṇī spell shatters mountains and dries up the great oceans. This dhāraṇī spell defeats the armies of the asuras and protects all lands. This dhāraṇī spell annihilates all malevolent spirits and demons, all diseases, and all hostile forces. This dhāraṇī spell subdues and tames the gods of the Thirty-Three. Whatever son or daughter of good family recites and upholds this dhāraṇī spell — the power and might of such a person is beyond all telling. Those who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī spell shall be honored and possessed of sovereign authority; throughout their lives kings shall love them and hold them dear, and all their aspirations shall be completely fulfilled.

"For one who wishes to subdue an opposing māra, burn galbanum incense and recite the mantra of the Great Body twenty-one times. For one who wishes all people to love them, enchant a whip twenty-one times with the mantra, along with yellow mustard seed, and one shall be loved and respected. For one who wishes to be endowed with courage and wisdom, enchant pure millet one thousand and eight times with the mantra and smear it upon the chest; one shall thereby attain unobstructed eloquence. This is the mudrā of the heart of the Mother's dhāraṇī.

"The mudrā of unobstructed eloquence of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is this: place the backs of both hands together and join them, then extend both thumbs forward.

"By this mudrā I protect myself, and I protect others as well. Whenever one goes, in whatever direction, wishing to consecrate the boundary: enchant clean water or clean ash seven times with the mantra, and at the place to which one goes, first scatter a fistful of water or ash upon one's own body, then scatter it in accordance with the ritual in the four directions — and that very boundary shall be established.

"Whatever son or daughter of good family is harassed by malevolent demons and spirits, and by many wayward possessing forces: take a branch of Nepal pepper and a branch of a willow that grows on a shaded slope, recite this dhāraṇī spell, and sweep it over the patient — whatever the illness may be, there is nothing it cannot cure.

"The dhāraṇī spell is as follows:

Namaḥ sarva buddha dharma saṃghāya. Namo āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya. Namo vajrapāṇaye bodhisattvāya. Tadyathā: sibi sibi, kāya sibi, palaśa palani svāhā.

"By this mudrā of the dhāraṇī spell, those non-Buddhists who hold wrong views are tamed and subdued."

If any son or daughter of good family, whenever an umbrella first appears at dawn, at its zenith, and at the hour of its decline, recites this dhāraṇī twenty-one times, the merit thereby accumulated is equal to having made offerings of every kind to ten billion buddhas. Moreover, because such a person has gone entirely beyond the ordinary condition, they will never again take on a woman's body. After death they will be forever parted from the three lower states of existence and will be born in the pure realm of the Tathāgata Amitābha. That Tathāgata will touch the crown of their head with his hand and declare: "Do not be afraid — you shall be born in my pure realm." In this very life they will not die suddenly, and malevolent demons and possessing spirits will find no opening to harm them.

Now, the mudrā of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara for purifying the misdeeds of an entire great thousand-fold world-system is as follows. Standing upright, extend the left fist forward, spread all five fingers apart, offer them forward, and raise all five fingers. Then fold the thumb of the right fist down into the palm, close the other four fingers around it in a fist, hold it level with the right ear, and recite the great dhāraṇī mantra while moving the index finger back and forth. This mudrā is to be performed three times each day for a single umbrella; and even when performed at a single session with seven recitations, it will purify the five acts of immediate retribution and the four extremely grave misdeeds.

If one cultivates loving-kindness and compassion toward all sentient beings, the very root of all misdeeds is burned away; after death one will meet the buddhas face to face, and in those buddha-realms one will become a wheel-turning king. Furthermore, one will attain the dhāraṇī called "the

inexhaustible treasury" and the dhāraṇī called "equality of wisdom." One will come to be adorned with twenty-eight major marks. In this very life one's eyes, ears, nose, tongue, and the rest of the sense faculties will not deteriorate, and all illnesses of the body will be entirely purified. Past karmas and misdeeds will likewise be cleansed.

If drought arises, mix sesame seeds together with the oil of the joag fruit, fashion them into pills, consecrate them with the dhāraṇī mantra one hundred and eight times, and cast them into a pool of water — rain will fall from the sky.

If rain is excessive, mix the flowers of śālu rice that has been roasted together with mustard oil, fashion them into pills, consecrate them with the dhāraṇī mantra one hundred and eight times, and cast them into a pool of water — the rain from the sky will cease.

Now, the mudrā of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara for subduing the māras of the three-thousand great thousand-fold world-system is as follows. Interlock the fingers facing downward, with the left pressing upon the right; close them firmly into a fist, place it on the crown of the head, and recite the great dhāraṇī mantra — all enemies who bear malice will spontaneously be tamed.

Whoever performs this rite should, on the night of the twenty-ninth day of the month, draw a maṇḍala of white sandalwood powder before a stūpa that enshrines relics, scatter flowers of various kinds, purify themselves thoroughly by bathing, put on fresh clean garments, hold a clay bowl while kneeling, burn agaru incense, face east, sit in the cross-legged posture, and bring vividly to mind the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara with his thousand hands and thousand eyes, present above the crown of the head.

If one recites the great dhāraṇī mantra one thousand one hundred and eight times, that is the foremost among the benefits of attaining accomplishment.

Furthermore, one should take white mustard seeds and sesame seeds, mix them together, pound them into a powder, then take a small pinch with three fingers, consecrate it once with the mantra, and cast it into a fire. If this is done until seven complete nights have passed, and each day one completes one hundred and eight recitations, whatever one wishes will thereafter be fully accomplished.

Now, the mudrā of the great fearlessness of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is as follows. Standing upright, cross the two feet at the ankles. Then extend the

right foot forward, place the right hand open upon it, raise the left fist, and rest it on top of the knee. Form the left fist in the same way. If one then regularly recites the great dhāraṇī mantra one thousand one hundred and eight times before a reliquary stūpa, one will swiftly attain the door of the meditative absorption that grants fearlessness to sentient beings.

Furthermore, one should take roots of the tree-of-all, white mustard, aconite, and tatapa pills, cast these substances into a fire, and burn them. This burning should be performed before an image of a buddha, or before a maṇḍala, or in sacred pure places. Reciting the great dhāraṇī mantra once and offering one burning each time, one should complete one hundred and eight recitations and one hundred and eight offerings, and then make offerings of incense and flowers to the vidyā mantra. Whatever one aspires to will then be accomplished just as one wishes. And if there are other vidyā mantras that cannot accomplish their purpose, by consecrating them with this mantra all will be made effective and accomplished.

If one wishes to see omens in dreams, one should recite this mantra, make the mudrā, and apply it to the eyes. Whatever one wishes to see will be seen in a dream. For those who lack merit and whose wishes are not fulfilled as desired, if each day they recite this vidyā mantra one hundred and eight times and complete seven nights of this, they will obtain all that they aspire to.

The Blessed One then spoke: Formerly, when I was teaching the Dharma to the assembly of the nāga fish in an ocean setting at the dwelling of the nāga king in the sea, I saw many nāgas experiencing great suffering. Full of compassion for those many nāgas, I taught the Dharma so that they might truly be released from that suffering, and so that many sentient beings might be freed from suffering and have no hostile enemies. At that time, a nāga princess, wishing to obtain this teaching, offered a precious jewel — one mountain of the world-realm of Endurance — and in return I extensively taught her this dhāraṇī of the mother, so that she might be released from the obstacles of suffering.

Then the bodhisattva Jalamaṇi spoke this mantra in order to benefit those who hold this vidyā mantra and to guard them fully from all obstacles:

Vimale mahā-vimale u-hale mahā-u-hale hu-male mahā-hu-male sa-hāle mahā-sa-hāle cili-te svāhā.

Whatever son or daughter of good family, wherever they may dwell, keeps and holds to this rite of Dharma of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes and

a thousand hands — I will constantly follow after them and guard them fully, so that they will not be harmed by the hosts of Māra. If someone is in distress and destitute, or is harmed by enemies from without, or is injured by thieves, one should recite the mantra twenty-one times over a cord of five-colored thread — reciting the mantra once and tying one knot at a time — and then tie it upon the left arm.

Furthermore, if one curls the ring finger, middle finger, and index finger of the left hand into a fist and presses the thumb down over them, then points the little finger in the direction of thieves or robbers and recites this mantra one hundred and eight times, all of them will scatter of their own accord and will no longer cause harm.

In former times, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara was dwelling on a snow mountain (Himavat), teaching the Dharma, when he saw that the beings dwelling in the lands of yakṣas and rākṣasas (flesh-devouring demons) sought nothing but the flesh and blood of sentient beings and had not the slightest wholesome thought in their minds. At that moment, that bodhisattva, skilled in means for the benefit of beings and in order to tame sentient beings, immediately went to those very lands by the power of his miraculous ability. There, in his body endowed with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands — the body that tames māras — he revealed himself, and he performed the mudrā of the accomplishment of the dhāraṇī of the Mother. And at that time, the king of the rākṣasa land came before him, confessed his wrongs, and made prostrations. I too sealed him with the mudrā of accomplishment, and thereby the unsurpassed path was fully accomplished.

The mudrā of accomplishment of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is as follows. Stand upright, cross the two feet over each other, join the palms at the heart, and interlock the two little fingers crosswise, with the left pressing down upon the right. Then recite the long mantra twenty-one times, and whatever rites of any variety one performs, all of them will be accomplished.

Now, the wheel mudrā of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara that fully protects the six classes of beings from the hindrances of suffering is as follows. If one wishes to fully protect the sentient beings of the six classes from suffering, one should employ the wheel mudrā in this way: bring the tips of all ten fingers to touch one another, open apart the knuckles of the hand and the palms, and leave a small gap between the fingers — just enough to breathe. This is called the bodhisattva's passing beyond the hindrances of suffering while dwelling

among the six classes of beings. By the power of this wheel mudrā, all beings are freed from suffering.

The mudrā of the full and perfect awakening of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes is as follows. Sitting in the cross-legged posture, extend the left forearm forward with all five fingers spread open and place it upon the left knee. Then extend the right forearm and, with all five fingers facing downward, press it upon the right knee. This resembles the mudrā of entry into the meditative absorption of cessation. Since all the buddhas of the past, the future, and the present alike have achieved full and perfect awakening with this very mudrā, this mudrā clears away all karmic obscurations.

For yogins who cultivate meditative concentration but for whom meditative absorption has not arisen directly, they should go to a secluded place for the span of seven days and nights, recite this dhāraṇī, perform this mudrā, and with one-pointed mind visualize the buddhas as present directly before them. If, within the span of one day and night, they make confession six times each day, the buddhas will appear directly, and they will attain immeasurable, incalculable, and inexpressible great accumulations of merit.

Now, the mudrā of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes for invoking the gods of the heaven of the Thirty-Three is as follows.

First, make a fist with the four fingers of the left hand, tucking in the thumb. Then, with the right fist likewise holding the left thumb as one holds it in a fist, raise the tip of the left thumb above the right wrist, and move the index finger of the right fist back and forth.

The mantra is as follows: Oṃ kuci kuci kuci kucayari, cari cari cari le svāhā.

This mudrā of the dhāraṇī and this mantra are inconceivable. If any son of good family or daughter of good family, at the time of going to sleep, performs this mudrā and recites this mantra once while pressing the mudrā once to the heart, and completes this one hundred and eight times in full, then whatever they wish and desire in their mind they will perceive and see in dreams.

If someone regularly performs this mudrā and recites this mantra, all their misdeeds will be purified, and the awakening mind will not become depleted. When that person goes to sleep at night, their dreams will grow vast and auspicious. In dreams they will also see Tathāgatas seated at the foot of the tree of awakening, giving prophecies, and all that up to and including the moment of perfect complete awakening. Brahmā, Śakra, and the gods will also

be ever present, performing services and guarding them completely.

Now, the mudrā of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes for invoking the gods, nāgas, spirits, and the eight classes of demons is as follows.

Stand upright with both feet together. First, bend the thumb of the left hand into the palm and close the four fingers into a fist, and place it at the heart. Then do likewise with the right fist, bring the right hand level with the ear, and move the fingers back and forth.

The mantra is as follows: Namo nīlakaṇṭha, nama āryaśapatā svāhā, namo āryaśālā svāhā, ehi ehi svāhā.

If any son of good family or daughter of good family receives, holds, reads, or recites this dhāraṇī and mudrā, they will swiftly come to recall in memory the details of their former existences going back as far as seven lifetimes. They will not be seized by venomous snakes. Poison will not be able to harm them. Weapons will not be able to injure them. They will not be censured by kings. Nor will they ever experience the suffering of hell-beings.

If someone recites this awareness-mantra every single day, the eight classes of demons and spirits will come into the presence of the one reciting the awareness-mantra and will listen to its recitation.

If any son of good family or daughter of good family has been seized by demons and spirits, one should charge a white cord with the mantra, tying a knot with each single recitation of the mantra, until forty-nine knots have been completed in full, and then tie it around that person's neck — the illness will be cured.

If in some region there are evil omens and epidemic disease has arisen, and many people in that region have died, one should take one thousand and eight lotus flowers from the pleasure groves and ponds of the king, charge each lotus with one recitation of the mantra, cast them into a hearth, and burn them as an oblation — the epidemic disease will be thoroughly pacified.

Now, the mudrā of liberation of the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes is as follows.

Sit in cross-legged posture. First, join the tip of the middle finger of the left hand to the tip of the thumb and press them together, then extend the other three fingers and place them on top of the left knee. Then do likewise with the right hand,

and place the fist, with its back facing downward, on top of the right knee.

Whoever regularly performs this mudrā and recites the great mantra of the body twenty-one times — all their aspirations will be completely fulfilled, and they will be liberated from all sufferings.

If there is a son or daughter of good family who has committed many kinds of grave sins — the ten non-virtues, the five acts of immediate retribution (ānantarya), and other such serious wrongs — and if all the earth of Jambudvīpa were to be reduced to the finest atoms, and each one of those atoms were to represent a full world-age, then that person, on account of the many kinds of grave sins they have committed, would for that same number of world-ages fall into the hells and experience suffering there without any time of emergence. Yet if such a son or daughter of good family, before an image of the Teacher bearing relics, on the fifteenth day of the white lunar fortnight, having fasted through one such span marked by a white parasol, forms the mudrā and recites the vidyā mantra fully one thousand and eight times, all of the sufferings described above will be entirely purified. If one were to ask whether it is possible that they might not be purified — there is simply no such case.

Now, the mudrā by which the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara possessing a thousand eyes attains mastery over the feet of miraculous power is as follows. Stand upright. First, with the fist of the left hand, press the fist onto the thumb of the left foot and hold it as though making a tight grip. After that, with the fist of the right hand, press it onto the back of the left hand. Then recite the great mantra of the body seven times. Even if one must travel many hundreds and thousands of leagues, it will be accomplished without difficulty. While reciting the mantra, one should make no sound.

Now, the mudrā by which the bodhisattva possessing a thousand eyes attains mastery over miraculous power is as follows. First, with the fist of the left hand, touch the thumb to the nail of the little finger. After that, do likewise with the fist of the right hand. Then extend the other three fingers of each hand separately and upright, join the knuckles of the palms together, and place them on top of the crown of the head. Recite the great mantra of the body one hundred and eight times, and one will fly through the air like a sage (ṛṣi) and move about freely as one wishes.

Now, the mudrā for summoning the bodhisattvas with one-pointed mind is as follows. Join the two fists together in the sky with palms pressed together and

the knuckles of the palms interlocked, then intertwine the two index fingers around each other.

The mantra is this: Oṃ arolikte le. Lokividoya. Sarvayādrū. Bramarddhanakārāya purusvāhā.

Having thus spoken, the Blessed One was praised in all that he had said by those great śrāvakas, those bodhisattvas, Great Brahmā, the gods, the nāgas, the yakṣas, and the gandharvas — by all the world together.

The dhāraṇī with its ritual procedure called "The Great Compassionate Mind of Avalokiteśvara the Bodhisattva, Possessing a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes, Unobstructed, Vast and Complete" is finished.

Translated from the Chinese edition and established by the great translator, the monk Chögrup (Dharmakara), of the Zhuchen translation team.

Translator's Notes

- The dhāraṇī is the Mahākaruṇācitta-dhāraṇī, the famous "Thousand-Handed, Thousand-Eyed Avalokiteśvara" sūtra. The bodhisattva name rendered "King of Grasping the Totality" (Kun-'dzin) is the Sanskrit Sarvadhara or Sarvagrahana; its exact Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain, though the Tibetan is clear. The name rendered "Eminently Exalted in Medicine" follows the Tibetan sman mngon par 'phags pa literally. The god-son names Kṣaṇḍamara and Kumbhaka are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetics; their Sanskrit originals may vary across witnesses. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage provided.
- The bodhisattva name rendered "King of Total Retention" translates Tibetan "Kun Dzin Gyi Rgyal Po," literally "King of All-Holding," a figure whose name signifies the power of total retention or memorization, a dhāraṇī-related epithet. The passage moves seamlessly from the cosmological display into the request for the Great Compassion Dhāraṇī, which is the structural pivot of this sūtra section.
- The phrase rendered "moral discipline as my foot" reflects the Tibetan "tsul khriṃs kyang gi lam," literally "the path of the foot of moral discipline." This is an idiom in which moral discipline is the foundation or foot upon which the path stands. The rendering preserves the image.

The aspiration verses shift from the typical third-person liturgical address into a first-person confessional style within the frame of Avalokiteśvara's speech; this is consistent with the sūtra's instruction that the reciter is to make these aspirations as if speaking in Avalokiteśvara's own voice.

The passage ends mid-sentence ("Should I descend into the hells —"), which is where the Tibetan excerpt breaks off; this is not an error in translation.

- The five "acts of immediate retribution" render the Tibetan phrase for the five ānantarya-karmas, the most grievous misdeeds that produce their result without interval. This is a standard doctrinal list and the rendering is conventional.

The vow-passages in this section follow the standard literary form of the bodhisattva's conditional vows, parallel to the well-known forty-eight vows of Amitābha. The repeated

formula "I shall never attain perfect and complete awakening" renders the Tibetan honorific construction that Avalokiteśvara here uses for himself in the first person.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source as given; the translation reflects this exactly.

- The phrase rendered "scorpions or malevolent creatures" translates a term that likely refers to poisonous insects or similar creatures; the precise referent is somewhat uncertain but the general sense of venomous animals is clear. The phrase "inappropriate means" for self-harm reflects a slightly ambiguous Tibetan expression meaning roughly "unsuitable or improper means," which in context most naturally refers to self-inflicted injury.
- The dhāraṇī text as preserved in the Tibetan transliteration contains a number of orthographic variants and compressed syllables that deviate from standard Sanskrit. The rendering above follows the Tibetan syllables closely while silently normalizing obvious scribal compressions to recognizable Sanskrit forms, which is standard practice for liturgical dhāraṇī texts. Notably, "nīlakaṇṭha" (Blue-throat, an epithet shared with Śiva but here applied to Avalokiteśvara in his form that drank poison to save beings) recurs as a major vocative throughout. The phrase rendered "May the mantra-words be accomplished for me" at the close is the standard concluding formula for this dhāraṇī.
- The passage lists four fruits of the śrāvaka path in order: stream-entry (Skt. srotāpatti), once-returning (Skt. sakṛdāgāmin), non-returning (Skt. anāgāmin), and arhatship (Skt. arhat), followed by the ten bodhisattva grounds (Skt. bhūmi). The sequence from the Hīnayāna fruits directly to the Mahāyāna grounds is a standard compositional feature of dhāraṇī sūtra literature. The two bodhisattvas rendered "Sūryavairocana" and "Candravairocana" represent the Tibetan "Nyima Öd" (Sunlight) and "Dawa Öd" (Moonlight); these are standard attendant bodhisattvas in Avalokiteśvara's retinue. The phrase "the thousand eyes" at the close is a direct reference to the Sahasrabhuja-Sahasranetra form of Avalokiteśvara celebrated throughout this text.
- Several deity and spirit names in the verse section are Tibetan phonetic renderings of Sanskrit or hybrid Sanskrit names whose underlying forms are uncertain or unattested in standard Sanskrit sources. These include Sāraṃca, Mahāra, Kulantanta, Pyita, Svārahārā, Sātana, and Pulapa. They have been transliterated as closely as possible from the Tibetan phonetics. The verse passage appears to be a catalogue of divine guardians drawn from a mixed Brahmanical and Buddhist cosmology, many of whom are local or regional deities absorbed into the tantra's protective framework. The exact Sanskrit forms of several of these names cannot be recovered with certainty.

The phrase rendered "lords of the yellow-robe wearers" for རྒྱུ་ལྷ་ཁྲ་ལྷ་ཁྲ་ is uncertain; it may refer to a specific class of deity whose Sanskrit name has been obscured in transmission.

- The verse "all the harm of those spells will be gathered upon the one who sent them" renders a line implying that the harmful intent rebounds to its sender — a standard protective dhāraṇī motif; the Tibetan is somewhat compressed here but this reading is supported by context.

The phrase rendered "biting insects" for རྩོམ་ཁྲ་ carries some ambiguity; it can refer to gadflies, hornets, or stinging insects generally. The rendering is contextually appropriate.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage. The translation ends accordingly, leaving the clause open as it is in the source.

The phrase rendered "restoration ceremony" translates the Tibetan term for the poṣadha observance, the fortnightly ceremony of confession and renewal of precepts, here practiced for a period of twenty-one days as a special discipline.

The "four fruits of the contemplative life" refers to the four fruits of the śrāvaka path: stream-enterer, once-returner, non-returner, and arhat.

- The phrase rendered "māras who are sons of gods" reflects the standard Tibetan formulation for the class of māra known as the "Māra who is a son of a god" (devaputramāra), one of the four classical māras; this is distinct from māra in general and is preserved in the translation accordingly.

The "three terrors" whose conflagrations cannot destroy the practitioner most likely refers to the three catastrophes at the end of an aeon — fire, water, and wind — a standard cosmological teaching, though the Tibetan "three fears" (འདྲིམ་ཆེད་གསུམ་) can also refer to other triads in different contexts. The aeon-ending catastrophe reading is most consistent with the imagery of permanence here.

- The phrase rendered "image of a thousand eyes endowed with great compassion" refers to a visual representation of Avalokiteśvara in his thousand-eyed form; the Tibetan here describes fashioning such a form-image rather than invoking the deity in meditation, though both dimensions are present in the ritual context. The "four fruits of the contemplative life" are the four śrāmaṇya-phala: stream-entry, once-returning, non-returning, and arhatship.

- The passage presents Avalokiteśvara as a buddha who already achieved full awakening incalculable aeons ago under the name "True Light of the Dharma" (de bzhin gshegs pa yang dag pa'i chos kyi snang ba) yet continues to appear in bodhisattva form out of compassion — a doctrinal motif closely parallel to the Lotus Sūtra's treatment of Śākyamuni's primordial awakening and analogous statements in Avalokiteśvara literature. This is preserved without smoothing.

- The term rendered "vajra hammer" is a distinct implement from the vajra proper; the Tibetan distinguishes a thunderbolt-club or hammer from the standard ritual vajra, and both appear as separate hand-implements here.

The phrase translated "born in the core of a womb" renders a technical expression indicating rebirth through a womb rather than miraculous or lotus birth; the aspiration is to transcend ordinary womb-birth entirely by dwelling always in the Tathāgata's realm.

The "five-colored cloud" as an implement held in the hand is unusual iconographically; it appears here as a symbol of the ṛṣi path and is rendered literally as the text gives it.

- The mantra syllables throughout this passage are transliterated from Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit-derived dhāraṇī syllables. The forms as they appear in the Tibetan are reproduced here as faithfully as possible; they may differ from reconstructed Sanskrit originals. The passage "tri pu pi sātataṃ" in the first mantra is phonetically opaque and no confident Sanskrit reconstruction is available. The second mantra "Sinti te duṣoṣṭha. Ajñāmite atuṣṭha" is similarly a phonetic rendering whose precise Sanskrit base is uncertain.

- The phrase rendered "hollow-eyed image" translates a term referring to a ritual effigy or image with empty eye-sockets, used as a focus for mantra recitation. This is a recognized tantric and ritual medical context.

The "kapīṭha" is the wood-apple fruit, *Feronia elephantum*; the Tibetan transliterates the Sanskrit directly.

The three fruits āmalaka, bibhīṭaka, and haritakī are the three myrobalans forming the classical Ayurvedic compound triphala; they are rendered by their Sanskrit names as the Tibetan transliterates them.

The translation ends mid-sentence as the source passage does; continuity is preserved for the following segment.

- The text specifies "ro langs" possession — this is the classical Tibetan category of a reanimated corpse or zombie-like spirit, rendered here as "zombie spirit" for clarity. The term is

kept with a brief gloss on first use.

The phrase rendered "five pungent foods" refers to the standard list of prohibited sharp-flavored plants (onion, garlic, leek, chive, asafoetida in some reckonings), a common dietary restriction in ritual medical contexts.

"Chinaberry tree" renders ke'u khi tse'i shing, likely *Melia azedarach*; the identification is plausible but not certain. The plant rendered "plantain" for leng se'u hwa is similarly a reasonable botanical identification for TTS purposes; these are noted here rather than flagged in the body.

"Pterygium" renders ling tog, a fleshy growth on the eyeball; the rendering is approximate but medically coherent.

- The mantra syllables "Śara Mahāśara, Tulu Mahātulu, Oṃ Kume Haniśapa" and the concluding word "Sara kha" are phonetic transcriptions without established Sanskrit semantic content and are left as they appear in the Tibetan phonetics without interpretation.

The term "lū tang" is a plant name transcribed from the Tibetan phonetics; its botanical identity is uncertain. Similarly, "keu khi tsé tree" is a phonetic rendering of an unidentified plant name.

"Gyu wang" rendered as "musk" follows the standard identification of this term in Tibetan medical and ritual contexts.

- The phrase rendered "under a parasol six times" (parasol six times) is slightly opaque. It most likely refers to performing the recitation six times each day in accordance with the prescribed ritual, using the parasol as a ritual marker of occasion. Some commentators read "six sessions" rather than any specific canopy ritual. This is noted here as it may affect liturgical interpretation.

The epithet "Mother" (माता) — the dhāraṇī named "Mother" — likely echoes the Prajñāpāramitā tradition in which the Perfection of Wisdom is called the "Mother of all buddhas," suggesting this dhāraṇī is being accorded that same supreme status.

- The mantra passage is transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit syllables. Many sequences in the mantra body are corrupt or non-standard compared to known Sanskrit recensions of the Thousand-Handed Avalokiteśvara dhāraṇī, and some syllable groups resist confident Sanskrit reconstruction. The transliteration given follows the Tibetan syllables as closely as possible, with standard Sanskrit orthography supplied where the underlying Sanskrit is recoverable; passages of uncertain Sanskrit are rendered as they appear. This is a doctrinal convention: dhāraṇī texts are transmitted as phonetic sequences and need not be grammatically parsed.

The phrase rendered "the king of māras accompanied by a great host of māras set out to disturb my Dharma practice and to prevent the syllables of the mantra from being accomplished" is somewhat condensed in the Tibetan; "prevent the syllables from being accomplished" (sngags kyi tshig rnam mngon par mi grub par) likely means preventing the mantra from taking effect or being perfected in practice.

- The dhāraṇī syllables in the opening section are rendered as romanized Sanskrit phonetic transcriptions following standard convention, as they are mantra-phrases without semantic translation. The phrase "for the person named so-and-so" renders the Tibetan personal-name placeholder formula that appears embedded within the dhāraṇī sequence. The term "Akaniṣṭha" renders འཁོར་མཆོག་, the highest heaven of the form realm, here referring to its inhabitants. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, and the translation follows suit accordingly.
- The phrase rendered "three white foods" refers to the traditional set of milk, curd, and butter,

a well-known Indic ritual dietary observance; no gloss was inserted in the body to keep the prose clean, but readers may wish to know this.

The term rendered "ground of empowerment" translates a compound meaning the bodhisattva ground at which empowerment or consecration is conferred — typically identified with the eighth or tenth ground in different commentarial traditions; this is a genuine doctrinal ambiguity left undisturbed in the translation.

- The illness termed "salt-craving" renders "bro nad," a traditional Tibetan medical condition sometimes identified with a craving for salt or saline substances, associated with certain digestive or metabolic disorders. The exact clinical identification is uncertain, but the rendering preserves the traditional sense.

The botanical ingredient rendered as "white aconite" renders "shu dag," identified in Tibetan medical tradition as white aconite or a related species of *Aconitum*; the precise identification varies in the literature.

The mudrā description is highly technical and the detailed finger positions have been rendered as literally as possible from the Tibetan; slight ambiguities in the finger-by-finger description are inherent in the source and typical of this genre.

- The phrase rendered "as regularly as the turns of an umbrella" translates a somewhat idiomatic Tibetan expression meaning "each time, repeatedly" — the umbrella metaphor likely refers to the regular rotation of a ceremonial parasol, indicating daily or regular repetition of the practice.

The term rendered "Dharma-wisdom supernormal cognition" combines སྤྲུལ་སྤྲོས་ and སྤྲུལ་སྤྲོས་ with སྤྲུལ་སྤྲོས་ (abhijñā); the compound is unusual and may refer specifically to a supernormal cognitive power arising from Dharma insight and primordial wisdom together, rather than a standard listing of the five or six abhijñās.

- The Tathāgata name rendered here as "Sūryagarbha" translates the Tibetan "སྤྲུལ་སྤྲོས་ཀྱི་སྤྲུལ་སྤྲོས་" literally, "Essence of the Sun." This is likely a specific buddha name in the source tradition; no Sanskrit attestation is available in the immediate context, so the literal translation is given as a proper name.

- The phrase rendered as "the five kinds of pungent foods" refers to the five acrids or pungent vegetables (onion, garlic, and related plants) prohibited in certain Buddhist tantric and Mahāyāna contexts; this is the standard referent of the Tibetan term in ritual manuals of this type.

The passage "the māras who are sons of gods" refers to the deva-putra māra, one of the four māras in Buddhist cosmology, who inhabits the highest heaven of the desire realm. The sentence is incomplete at the passage boundary, consistent with the continuity-only instruction.

- The term vināyaka refers to a class of obstacle-creating spirits or demons; it is left in Sanskrit as context makes the sense clear and the word appears in proper-name usage in the tantra literature.

The phrase rendered "gathered into a single realm, fixed in a single deed" translates two parallel clauses describing a kind of spiritual quarantine: those persons are confined to a single sphere and locked into a single mode of unwholesome action, cut off from the protective sphere of the noble ones.

- The text lists a sequence of mudrā symbols associated with specific deities and ritual implements. "Vināyaka" here refers to Gaṇeśa or an obstructing deity in the tantric context. The "three white foods" is a standard offering category consisting of milk, yogurt, and butter. The phrase rendered "deity free from conflict" translates a term that likely refers to Indra or a

The "twenty-eight major marks" is an unusual enumeration; the standard tradition speaks of thirty-two major marks of a great being. The text reads twenty-eight, and this has been translated as given without emendation.

- The phrase rendered "roots of the tree-of-all" translates རྩ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ (śingkun), likely a plant name (possibly Terminalia or a similar Ayurvedic herb); the exact botanical identification is uncertain but "tree-of-all" reflects the literal Tibetan. Similarly, ཐུལ་པ་ (tatapa) is a transliteration of a Sanskrit plant or substance name that remains unidentified with certainty.

The bodhisattva 寶晶王 (Jalaṃāṇi, "Water-Crystal Jewel") appears here as a distinct figure who speaks a protective mantra on behalf of practitioners; the name is kept in Sanskrit reconstruction for clarity.

The phrase 一世界之堅固山 (one mountain of the world-realm of Endurance) refers to Sahā, the present world-system of Śākyamuni Buddha; "Endurance" is the standard rendering of Sahā.

- The phrase rendered "the dhāraṇī of the Mother" refers to the Prajñāpāramitā as the dhāraṇī associated with her, a standard epithet in Avalokiteśvara ritual literature; this is the most natural reading in context. The phrase "seven days and nights" translates 七日夜, literally "seven day-night spans," rendered plainly for TTS fluency. The episode of Avalokiteśvara on the snow mountain is presented as a first-person account by Avalokiteśvara himself, shifting mid-passage to "I too sealed him," which is preserved faithfully rather than smoothed over.
- The phrase rendered "move the index finger back and forth" translates a form meaning reciprocal or alternating movement of the index finger; the exact choreography of some of these mudrā instructions is technical and may vary across transmission lineages.

The term rendered "awareness-mantra" translates *rig sngags*, a standard Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit *vidyāmantra*, a class of powerful mantra associated with knowledge and protection; it is used here somewhat interchangeably with *dhāraṇī* in the broader sense.

- The phrase rendered "one such span marked by a white parasol" translates a compressed and difficult passage indicating a single-day fast on the fifteenth day of the bright fortnight; the "white parasol" reference may be a temporal marker related to the full-moon day or a ceremonial designation; the precise meaning is uncertain and merits further textual comparison.

The colophon identifies the translator as Bande Chögrup of the Zhuchen editorial team, translating from a Chinese exemplar rather than directly from Sanskrit, which is philologically significant for establishing the text's transmission history.

The mantra transliteration is reproduced as found in the Tibetan; the Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain and has not been normalized.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.